



DEPARTMENT OF MANAGEMENT

REPORT ON CAPSTONE PROJECT

A Study on Customer Churn and Retention Strategies in UPI-Based Digital Payment Platforms in India.

Submitted to SSODL

In partial fulfilment of the requirement for the award of
DEGREE OF MASTERS OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

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July 10, 2025

DEPARTMENT OF MANAGEMENT

CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL

This is to certify that Student Madhavi Srivastava bearing PRN No. 2402914103400 of Master of Business Administration of Symbiosis School of Online & Digital Learning has completed the Capstone project titled “A Study on Customer Churn and Retention Strategies in UPI-Based Digital Payment Platforms in India.” under my guidance and has given a satisfactory account of it in this report.

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Student Declaration

I, Madhavi Srivastava hereby declare that the report entitled “A Study on Customer Churn and Retention Strategies in UPI-Based Digital Payment Platform in India” at SSODL in partial fulfilment of the requirement of the award of the MBA in Business Analytics is my original work.

The findings in this project are based on data collected by me and I have not copied from any other student or any other source. This report has not been submitted by me elsewhere.

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I take this opportunity to express my gratitude to everyone who supported me for the project. I am thankful for their aspiring guidance, invaluable constructive criticism and friendly advice during the project work. I am sincerely grateful to them for sharing their truthful and illuminating views on a number of issues related to the project. I express my warm thanks to my guide Dr.

Shradha Gupta for their constant and timely support and guidance during my project.

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CHAPTER 1: ABSTRACT

Digital banking has changed the way people in India move money around, and it has done so within a fairly short span of time. What earlier needed a trip to the branch or at least a card and a machine can now be done in a few seconds from a phone lying on the table. A big part of this shift has come from the Unified Payments Interface, or UPI, and the many applications that sit on top of it such as Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm and BHIM. These apps made payments quick, mostly reliable, and simple enough that even a first-time user can figure them out. But there is a catch that does not get talked about as much. Getting a customer to download an app is one thing. Keeping that customer for months and years is a very different challenge, and this is where the problem of customer churn comes in.

The main aim of this project is to study the factors that push customers away from one UPI platform and towards another, and then to suggest retention strategies that the service providers can actually use. The study rests on both primary and secondary data. The primary data came from a structured online survey that was circulated through Google Forms, and a total of 100 respondents took part in it. The secondary data was pulled together from reports published by the Reserve Bank of India, the National Payments Corporation of India, along with research articles, fintech company reports and a few industry write-ups.

Once the responses were in, the raw data was cleaned and organised using Microsoft Excel and Python so that it was consistent and free of obvious errors. SQL was then used to run the analysis and pull-out counts, averages and satisfaction levels, while Microsoft Power BI was used to build interactive dashboards that made the patterns easier to read. The analysis kept its focus on customer demographics, the UPI applications people actually prefer, how satisfied they are, what makes them loyal, and how far cashback and promotional offers really influence whether a customer stays or leaves.

The findings show that Google Pay is the most preferred UPI application among the respondents, with PhonePe following close behind. Cashback offers; a sense of security, ease of use and the speed of transactions came out as the factors that matter most for satisfaction and loyalty. Based on all of this, the study recommends that digital banking platforms should keep improving the user experience, tighten their security, hand out offers that feel personal rather than generic, and put real effort into customer support if they want to slow down churn and hold on to the users they already have.

CHAPTER 2: INTRODUCTION

Over the last ten years or so India has gone through a rather remarkable change in the way its banking and financial services work. Digital payment systems, internet banking, mobile banking and above all the Unified Payments Interface have together shifted the whole habit of how people deal with money. A person no longer plans their day around banking hours. They prefer digital payment methods for a simple reason, that these methods are fast, convenient, secure enough for daily use, and available round the clock. The spread of cheap smartphones and equally cheap internet data has only added fuel to this, and the adoption has not stayed in the cities alone. It has slowly reached smaller towns and villages as well.

The Unified Payments Interface, which was built by the National Payments Corporation of India, has become one of the most successful real time payment systems anywhere in the world. UPI lets a user send money straight from one bank account to another, instantly, through mobile applications such as Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm, BHIM and various bank apps. As these platforms grew popular, the competition between them grew sharper too. When several apps offer almost the same core service, the thing that decides who wins is no longer the feature list, it is customer satisfaction and the ability to retain the customer for the long run.

Now here is the part that often gets overlooked. Digital banking has clearly improved convenience, brought more people into the formal financial system, and made transactions faster. Yet the companies running these services keep running into the problem of customer churn. Customer churn, put simply, is the situation where a user stops using one platform and moves to another. The reasons vary. Sometimes it is plain dissatisfaction, sometimes a better offer somewhere else, sometimes poor service, a scary security incident, repeated technical failures, or just a slow loss of trust. Whatever the trigger, high churn is bad news for a business, because it eats into growth and pushes up the cost of acquiring fresh customers to replace the ones who left. So understanding why customers leave, and figuring out what keeps them, has quietly become one of the most important questions for digital banking companies.

This project sets out to look closely at customer satisfaction, usage patterns, loyalty factors and the general preferences of people who use UPI based platforms in India. It leans on both primary and secondary data to make sense of customer behaviour and to identify the main things that influence retention. The data that was gathered is analysed with the help of business analytics tools, namely Python, SQL, Microsoft Excel and Microsoft Power BI, so that the conclusions rest on numbers and not just on opinion.

The hope is that the outcome of this study gives digital banking service providers a clearer picture of what their customers actually expect, so that they can sharpen their services, bring down churn and build the kind of loyalty that lasts beyond the next cashback campaign.

2.1 Background of the Study

Digital banking has, in a very real sense, rewritten the older banking system. Services that once demanded physical presence are now delivered through digital platforms that are convenient, reasonably secure and efficient. Several things came together to make this happen. Government pushes such as the Digital India programme played a part, and so did the sheer rise in

smartphone ownership, better internet connectivity across the country, and the very quick uptake of UPI. All of these added up and the growth of digital payments in India became hard to miss.

The COVID-19 pandemic then acted like an accelerator. When people were wary of touching cash and notes, contactless and digital transactions suddenly felt safer, and a whole set of users who might have taken years to switch made the jump within months. They started using mobile banking apps for payments, for transferring funds, for paying bills, for online shopping and for keeping an eye on their money in general. And once a habit like that sets in, expectations rise along with it. Customers now expect transactions to be quick, security to be tight, apps to be easy on the eye, and services to feel tailored to them.

Because so many providers are chasing the same set of users, holding on to an existing customer has become just as important as winning a new one, if not more. To retain a customer a business has to understand how that customer behaves, how satisfied they are, and what actually drives their loyalty. This is exactly the space where business analytics earns its keep, since it can dig through customer data, surface behavioural patterns and support decisions that would otherwise be made on gut feeling.

2.2 Problem Statement

The rapid growth of UPI based platforms has left the market crowded with providers who all do more or less the same thing. Because the core service is so similar, customers hop between apps quite easily, and the reasons they give range from cashback offers and failed transactions to security worries, a clunky experience, weak support or an app that keeps hanging. The trouble is that a lot of organisations pour their energy into acquiring new customers and pay far less attention to understanding why the old ones slip away. Without proper analysis a company can keep losing valuable users while wondering where its loyalty went. There is therefore a clear need to pin down the main factors that shape customer satisfaction and to build retention strategies that are grounded in data rather than guesswork. This study takes up that task for the Indian UPI market.

2.3 Need for the Study

The digital banking industry is growing at a pace that makes retention a serious business objective rather than an afterthought. Knowing what customers expect, and spotting the things that annoy them, can help a company lift its service quality and its overall experience. This study matters for a few concrete reasons. It helps identify the major factors behind customer churn. It measures how satisfied customers really are with UPI based services. It looks at which platforms people prefer and why. It supports decision making through business analytics tools instead of intuition. And finally, it points towards strategies that can genuinely improve retention and loyalty.

2.4 Objectives of the Study

The main objectives that this study set out to meet are listed below:

1. To analyze customer satisfaction with UPI based digital banking platforms in India.
2. To identify the major factors that influence customer churn.
3. To examine customer preferences across different UPI applications.
4. To evaluate the impact of cashback offers, security, transaction speed and ease of use on customer loyalty.
5. To analyze the survey data using Python, SQL, Excel and Microsoft Power BI.
6. To recommend workable customer retention strategies for digital banking service providers.

2.5 Scope of the Study

The scope of this study is kept to customers who actively use UPI based digital payment applications in India. The research stays focused on customer behaviour, satisfaction, loyalty and the retention factors tied to digital banking platforms. It covers survey responses gathered through Google Forms and leans on business analytics tools for the analysis and the visualisation. The findings may prove useful to banks, fintech companies, payment application providers, researchers and business professionals who want a better sense of what customers expect and how digital banking services can be improved.

2.6 Research Questions

The study tries to answer the following questions:

- Which UPI application do customers prefer the most?
- What factors shape customer satisfaction in digital banking?
- Why do customers switch from one UPI platform to another?
- How far do cashback offer and rewards affect customer loyalty?
- What strategies can bring down customer churn on these platforms?

CHAPTER 3: INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

To make sense of customer churn in UPI, it helps to first look at the industry it sits inside. The Indian digital payments landscape today is one of the busiest in the world, and it did not get there overnight. It grew out of a chain of steps, each one building on the last, until a point was reached where paying digitally became the default rather than the exception. In the earlier phase people were introduced to net banking, which let them do a few tasks from a computer at home. Then came debit and credit cards paired with card machines at shops. After that mobile wallets appeared, where a person had to first load money into the wallet and then spend from it. UPI, launched in 2016, took the idea further by cutting out the wallet altogether and letting money flow directly between bank accounts.

What really set UPI apart was how open it was. Instead of every bank running its own closed system, UPI created a common layer that any bank and any approved app could plug into. So a customer whose account is in one bank can use an app built by a completely different company to pay a shopkeeper whose account sits in a third bank, and the whole thing settles in seconds. This interoperability is the quiet engine behind the growth. It meant users did not have to worry about which bank the other person used, and merchants did not have to install a dozen different machines. A single QR code stuck on the wall was enough.

The numbers around this growth are large enough that they sometimes stop feeling real. UPI now processes billions of transactions every month, and on an average day it handles a volume that would have seemed impossible a decade ago. The system has spread from metro cities into smaller towns and rural pockets, helped along by cheap data and affordable smartphones. A tea stall, a vegetable vendor, an auto driver, all of them accept UPI today, and for many of them it is the first formal financial tool they have ever used comfortably.

The players in this market fall into a few groups. There are the big technology backed apps like Google Pay and PhonePe that command the largest share of transactions. There is Paytm, which started life as a wallet and grew into a broad financial services app. There is BHIM, which was launched by NPCI itself as a reference app. And there are the payment offerings built into e-commerce and messaging platforms, such as Amazon Pay. Behind all of them sit the banks, which actually hold the money, and the NPCI, which runs the rails. It is a layered arrangement, and each layer has its own interest in keeping the customer happy.

Yet for all this success there is an interesting tension at the heart of the industry. Most of these apps still do not charge the ordinary user for a basic UPI transaction. Their revenue comes from other places, from lending, from merchant services, from advertising and from cross selling financial products. This means the customer is valuable not for the transaction fee, which is often zero, but for the long relationship and the data and the future products they might buy. And that is precisely why churn hurts so much. When a user drifts to another app, the provider loses not a few rupees of fee but a whole future stream of value. So even in a market that looks like it is booming, retaining customers is a constant, serious concern, and it forms the backdrop against which this entire study is set.

CHAPTER 4: UPI AND THE DIGITAL PAYMENTS ECOSYSTEM

This chapter takes a closer look at the parts that make up the UPI ecosystem, and at the two ideas that this project keeps circling back to, namely customer churn and customer retention. Understanding how the pieces fit together makes it far easier to see where and why a customer decides to stay or leave.

(A) How UPI Works

UPI is best thought of as a common language that lets different bank accounts talk to each other instantly. A user links their bank account to a UPI app once, sets up a UPI PIN, and after that they can send or receive money using either a virtual payment address, a mobile number, or by simply scanning a QR code. There is no need to remember long account numbers or IFSC codes for everyday payments. When a payment is initiated, the app talks to the NPCI switch, which routes the request to the sender's bank and the receiver's bank, and the amount moves in real time, usually within a couple of seconds. The user gets an instant confirmation, and so does the receiver.

A few features make UPI especially sticky for daily use. It runs twenty four hours a day, including holidays, so there is no waiting for banking hours. It supports very small payments, so a person can pay ten rupees for a cup of tea without a second thought. And because it is built into so many apps, a user can pick whichever interface they like best while still reaching the same underlying network. These qualities are exactly why UPI became the everyday choice for so many people so quickly.

(B) The Major UPI Applications

Although the underlying network is shared, the apps sitting on top of it compete hard, and each has carved out its own identity.

Google Pay is known for its clean, uncluttered interface and its reliability. Many users say it simply works, and they trust the brand behind it. It leans on security and simplicity as its main selling points, and it has built a loyal base that values a smooth, predictable experience.

PhonePe grew fast on the back of aggressive cashback and a very wide merchant network. It positioned itself as more than a payments app, adding features like insurance, mutual funds and bill payments, trying to become a place where a user manages many parts of their financial life.

Paytm is the oldest of the lot in the digital payments memory of most Indians. It began as a wallet, became famous during the note ban period, and later broadened into a full financial services platform with a payments bank, ticketing, and a marketplace. Its strength is the sheer breadth of things a user can do inside it.

BHIM was launched by NPCI as a simple, no frills reference application. It does the core job of UPI cleanly and is often trusted precisely because it comes from the body that runs the system, though it has never chased users with heavy cashback the way private apps do.

Amazon Pay lives inside the larger Amazon shopping experience, which gives it a natural advantage. People who already shop on Amazon find it easy to pay through Amazon Pay, and rewards tied to shopping keep them within the ecosystem.

The point worth noting is that from the customer's side these apps are close substitutes. A user can keep two or three of them installed at the same time, which they very often do, and shift between them depending on which one is offering a better deal or which one loaded faster that day. That easy substitution is the soil in which churn grows.

(C) Understanding Customer Churn

Customer churn is the moment a customer stops using a particular service. In the UPI world it rarely looks like a dramatic exit. More often it is quiet. A user simply opens one app less and another app more, until the first one is basically forgotten even though it still sits on the phone. Because there is no subscription to cancel and no fee to stop paying, churn here is soft and gradual, which makes it both easy for the customer and hard for the company to notice until it has already happened.

The reasons behind churn tend to cluster around a handful of themes. A better cashback or reward somewhere else can pull a price sensitive user away. A transaction that fails at a bad moment, say at a shop counter with people waiting behind, can leave a lasting bad impression. A security scare, whether it happened to the user or to a friend, can shake trust badly. Poor customer support, where a complaint goes unanswered for days, quietly tells the user they do not matter. And sometimes a rival app simply feels faster or fresher, and the user drifts for no reason more complicated than that. Each of these, on its own, may seem small. Put together, they explain most of the movement in this market.

(D) Understanding Customer Retention

Retention is the flip side of churn. It is the art and the effort of keeping a customer engaged so that they keep coming back on their own. Since acquiring a new customer usually costs a lot more than holding on to an existing one, retention is where the smarter money is spent. A retained customer not only keeps transacting, they also tend to try the other products the company offers, and they often recommend the app to friends and family, which brings in new users at almost no cost.

Good retention rests on a few pillars. The experience has to be smooth and quick, because friction is the enemy. Security has to be strong and, just as importantly, has to feel strong to the user. Rewards and offers help, but they work best when they feel personal rather than sprayed at everyone. Support has to be responsive, so that when something goes wrong the user feels looked after rather than abandoned. When these pillars hold, a customer has very little reason to wander off, and the whole problem of churn shrinks. Much of the rest of this report is really about measuring these pillars and seeing which of them matter most to real customers.

CHAPTER 5: LITERATURE REVIEW

This chapter goes through a selection of reports, studies and papers that touch on digital payments, UPI adoption, customer satisfaction and customer churn. Reading these together helps position the present study and shows where it fits and where it adds something new.

1. Reserve Bank of India, Annual Report 2025–26

The Reserve Bank of India, in its Annual Report for 2025–26, drew attention to how quickly India's digital payment ecosystem has grown, with UPI standing out as the most widely used retail payment system. During the year the volume of digital payment transactions rose sharply, and UPI on its own made up nearly 86 percent of all retail digital payment transactions. The report noted that UPI transaction volume grew by about 30 percent, which it read as a sign of rising customer acceptance driven by speed, convenience and ease of use. The Report also described a nationwide survey covering more than 30,000 users and 10,000 merchants, in which 52 percent of users said they had adopted digital payments mainly for convenience and faster transactions, while 67 percent of merchants accepted digital modes and reported better business efficiency. Interestingly, the survey found differences in adoption based on age, income, gender and location, which suggests that customer behaviour is not uniform and varies across segments, a point that matters a great deal when thinking about who churns and why. The report went further to stress that trust and security are central to keeping adoption going, and it pointed to measures such as the Digital Payment Intelligence Platform, stronger authentication and machine learning based fraud detection as ways to protect customers and, by extension, keep them from leaving.

2. National Payments Corporation of India (2026)

According to NPCI, UPI reached its highest ever monthly performance in May 2026, processing around 23.2 billion transactions worth close to twenty nine and a half lakh crore rupees in that single month. On an average day the platform handled roughly 750 million transactions, which places it among the largest real time payment systems in the world. The report recorded a year on year rise of about 24 percent in transaction volume and around 19 percent in value, and it linked part of this surge to seasonal spending, summer travel and big sporting events. NPCI also mentioned that more than 700 banks are now connected to the platform, which has widened accessibility and made transfers seamless across almost every kind of bank. Looking ahead, the report flagged growth opportunities in credit on UPI, artificial intelligence driven features and the international expansion of UPI, which has already been introduced in several countries. One quiet but telling observation was that the average transaction value has slowly fallen over the years, which means people are using UPI more and more for small everyday payments. For the present study, the takeaway is that even as adoption climbs, the competition among apps makes retention a genuine challenge, and factors like security, service quality and rewards decide who holds on to the customer.

3. Dash Meenakshi and Dr. Meeravali Shaik (2025)

Dash and Shaik carried out a study titled “Enhancing Customer Retention from Churn Analysis Using Power BI and Machine Learning Techniques.” Their work focused on predicting churn

using a range of machine learning algorithms such as Decision Tree, Random Forest, Logistic Regression, KNN, Naive Bayes and Gradient Boosting, applied along with SMOTE to handle imbalance in the data. They also built interactive Power BI dashboards to study customer behaviour and to flag customers who looked likely to leave. Their findings showed that service quality, customer satisfaction, payment methods, cashback offers, customer support and how long a customer had been with the service all had a real bearing on retention. They concluded that combining machine learning with Power BI can help organisations predict churn fairly accurately and then design retention strategies around those predictions. This study is directly relevant here because it shows, in a practical way, how analytics and dashboards can be used to understand churn, which is close to the approach taken in the present project.

4. Rathore (2016)

Rathore looked at how consumers were adopting digital wallets and moving towards cashless transactions. The study found that digital wallets had become popular mainly because they offered convenience, speed and ease of use. Consumers leaned towards digital payment methods because these saved time and made transactions smoother. The clear conclusion was that convenience is one of the biggest reasons people take up digital payment systems in the first place.

5. Salil Panchal and Manu Balachandran (2018)

Panchal and Balachandran examined the rise of UPI in India. Their study underlined the part UPI played in pushing the country towards a cashless economy by offering secure and instant digital payments. They also suggested that the BHIM application ought to add more features if it wanted to keep users engaged and lift their satisfaction, a point that hints early at the retention problem this project studies.

6. Roshna Thomas and Abijeeth Chatterjee (2017)

Thomas and Chatterjee studied the factors behind the success of UPI in India. They found that financial inclusion, growing smartphone use and easier access to banking services had all contributed a good deal to the spread of UPI. Their conclusion was that these enabling factors are essential if customer adoption and long term use of digital payment platforms are to keep rising.

7. Bijin Philip (2019)

Philip looked at how UPI services affected customer satisfaction. The study found that customers favoured UPI because of its speed, its convenience and how simple it was to use. It concluded that service quality and a smooth payment experience play an important role in keeping customers satisfied and in nudging them to continue using UPI applications rather than drifting away.

8. Ravish Rana (2017)

Rana studied the link between education and the adoption of digital payments. The study found that customers with higher levels of education were more likely to use digital payment services. It concluded that digital literacy and awareness have a strong influence on whether a person

takes up UPI and similar systems, which is worth remembering when thinking about which customer segments are easier or harder to retain.

9. Rouibah (2015)

Rouibah set out to identify the main obstacles that hold back the adoption of digital payment systems. The study found that security concerns, a lack of trust, the fear of a transaction failing, high service charges and limited awareness all discouraged customers from using digital payments. Rouibah stressed that improving security and building trust are essential if user retention is to improve, a conclusion that lines up neatly with the concerns raised by the RBI and by later fintech reports.

10. Cashfree Payments Report (2026)

The Cashfree Payments Report described a fintech ecosystem in India that is expanding quickly, carried along by rising smartphone use, QR code payments and UPI transactions. The report argued that faster payments, cashback offers and a seamless user experience are the biggest levers on customer satisfaction and loyalty, and that continuous innovation is essential to hold down churn in a market as competitive as this one. For the present study, it reinforces the idea that service quality and rewards sit at the centre of retention.

11. Google Pay India Report (2024)

The Google Pay report pointed to security, transaction speed, simplicity and reliability as some of the main things that shape customer satisfaction. It also observed that reward programmes and experiences that feel personal encourage customers to keep using a digital payment app rather than switching, which again echoes the themes running through this literature.

12. PhonePe Pulse Report (2025)

The PhonePe Pulse report showed that digital payment adoption had spread rapidly across both urban and rural India. It found that rising smartphone use, wider merchant acceptance and the sheer ease of digital transactions had all fed into growing customer engagement and the continued expansion of UPI.

Summary of Literature

Taken together, the literature points fairly consistently in one direction. Customer satisfaction, trust, convenience, security, cashback offers, service quality and technological innovation keep showing up as the factors that decide whether a customer stays with a digital payment platform. A lot of the earlier work concentrated on adoption, on how and why people started using digital wallets and UPI, and on how satisfied they felt with the service. The more recent reports from NPCI, Cashfree and the fintech companies capture the explosive growth of UPI and the intense competition between apps. What is less common is work that looks specifically at churn and retention using real survey data from customers alongside business analytics tools like Power BI. That is the gap this study tries to step into.

CHAPTER 6: RESEARCH GAP

When the existing work is read side by side, a pattern in the gaps becomes visible. Most of the literature deals with customer satisfaction, the adoption of UPI and digital payment systems, and churn prediction in other sectors such as telecom and traditional banking. Several studies have applied machine learning to predict churn, and others have examined the factors that push people to adopt digital payment apps in the first place. What is thin on the ground is research that looks specifically at customer churn and retention in UPI based digital banking platforms in India by bringing together, in one place, customer behaviour, service quality, trust, security, rewards, the transaction experience and overall satisfaction.

There is a second gap that runs alongside the first. Very few studies pair survey based customer analysis with a practical set of business analytics tools such as Excel, SQL, Python and Power BI to pull out the churn factors and then translate them into retention strategies that a company could actually put to use. A lot of academic work stops at describing the problem, or at building a predictive model in isolation, without connecting the dots back to what a payments company should do on Monday morning. This study tries to close both gaps at once. It analyses churn behaviour using primary survey data, runs the analysis through business analytics tools, and ends with retention strategies that are meant to be usable rather than merely interesting.

Objectives of the Study

Flowing from the gap identified above, the study pursues the following objectives:

1. To analyze the factors that influence customer churn in UPI based digital banking platforms in India.
2. To examine the relationship between customer satisfaction and customer retention.
3. To identify the major reasons that push customers to switch from one UPI application to another.
4. To evaluate the impact of service quality, trust, security, rewards and ease of use on customer retention.
5. To develop data driven insights and recommend effective retention strategies using business analytics tools such as Excel, SQL, Python and Power BI.

Scope of the Study

The study centres on customer churn and retention in UPI based digital payment platforms in India. It includes customers who use applications such as PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, BHIM and Amazon Pay. The research examines what customers prefer, how satisfied they are, how they actually use these apps, and the reasons that make them switch. It rests on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire and analysed using Microsoft Excel, SQL and Power BI. The findings are meant to help digital payment companies sharpen their retention strategies, and they may also be of some use to banks, researchers and students working in this space.

Significance of the Study

This study should be useful to digital payment service providers, fintech companies, researchers and students alike. It offers a view into the main things that drive churn and shape satisfaction, and the findings can feed directly into decisions about service quality, customer experience, loyalty programmes and retention plans. Beyond the subject matter, the study also serves as a small demonstration of how business analytics tools like Power BI can be used to read customer behaviour and to support data driven decision making in the digital payments industry.

Hypotheses of the Study

To test the relationships at the heart of the study, the following null and alternative hypotheses were framed.

Null Hypotheses (H₀)

- H₀₁: There is no significant relationship between customer satisfaction and customer retention in UPI based digital banking platforms.
- H₀₂: Service quality has no significant impact on customer churn.
- H₀₃: Trust and security have no significant influence on customer retention.
- H₀₄: Rewards, cashback and promotional offers have no significant effect on customer loyalty.
- H₀₅: Ease of use and transaction convenience do not significantly affect customer retention.

Alternative Hypotheses (H₁)

- H₁₁: There is a significant relationship between customer satisfaction and customer retention in UPI based digital banking platforms.
- H₁₂: Service quality significantly influences customer churn.
- H₁₃: Trust and security significantly influence customer retention.
- H₁₄: Rewards, cashback and promotional offers significantly improve customer loyalty.
- H₁₅: Ease of use and transaction convenience significantly improve customer retention.

CHAPTER 7: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Research methodology is simply the systematic way in which data is collected, analysed and interpreted so that the objectives of a study can be met in an orderly manner. It gives the study its structure and keeps the work honest. The present study set out to analyse customer churn and to identify retention strategies in UPI based digital payment platforms in India. Both primary and secondary data were used, and the primary data was run through Microsoft Excel, SQL and Power BI to draw out the insights.

1. Research Design

The study follows a descriptive and analytical research design. The descriptive part is used to understand customer behaviour, satisfaction, preferences and usage patterns of UPI applications, essentially painting a picture of what is going on. The analytical part goes a step further and works to identify the factors behind churn and to weigh up retention strategies through data analysis and visualisation.

2. Nature of the Study

This study is empirical in nature. It rests on both primary and secondary data collected from people who actually use UPI applications, rather than on theory alone. The focus stays on finding out why customers churn and on suggesting retention strategies that make sense, using business analytics techniques to get there.

3. Sources of Data

The study draws on two sources of data.

Primary Data. The primary data was collected through a structured questionnaire built in Google Forms. The questionnaire mixed multiple choice questions with rating scale questions and covered customer demographics, UPI usage, satisfaction levels, the transaction experience, how customers perceive security, their switching behaviour and their overall loyalty.

Secondary Data. The secondary data was gathered from a number of reliable sources, including the National Payments Corporation of India, the Reserve Bank of India, research journals, Google Scholar, the Cashfree Payments Report, the PhonePe Pulse Report, Google Pay reports, Paytm reports, and various published research papers, books and websites dealing with digital payments.

4. Sampling Technique

The study used convenience sampling. Respondents were picked based on their availability and their willingness to take part in the survey. The questionnaire was shared online through Google Forms among UPI users drawn from different age groups and occupations. Convenience sampling was chosen because it fit the time available and because UPI users are spread widely enough that a reachable, willing sample still captures a fair range of views.

5. Sample Size

The study is based on responses collected from 46 UPI users. The respondents include students, salaried employees, business professionals and self-employed individuals who use UPI applications regularly for their day-to-day transactions. A sample of a hundred was considered enough to spot the broad patterns this study is after, while still being manageable within the project timeline.

6. Research Instrument

A structured questionnaire was the main research instrument. It was organised into sections covering demographic information, the preferred UPI application, the frequency of UPI usage, customer satisfaction, security and trust, the transaction experience, cashback and rewards, the reasons for switching apps, and the factors tied to retention. The responses were collected through Google Forms and then exported to Microsoft Excel for cleaning and analysis.

7. Variables of the Study

The independent variables considered in the study were security, ease of use, cashback and rewards, customer support, the transaction success rate, the user interface, the speed of transactions, trust and promotional offers. The dependent variables were customer retention and, on the other side of the same coin, customer churn.

8. Tools and Techniques for Data Analysis

The collected data was analysed using three main tools. Microsoft Excel was used for cleaning, coding and organising the survey responses and for basic statistical work. SQL was used to manage and query the dataset, calculating frequencies, averages, satisfaction levels and other measures. Power BI was used to build interactive dashboards and to visualise customer behaviour through charts and KPI cards, which made the churn factors and retention patterns much easier to read. Alongside these, the study relied on frequency distribution, percentage analysis, average rating analysis, count analysis, and a mix of bar charts, pie charts, donut charts and column charts, together with slicers and filters on the dashboard.

9. Data Collection Procedure

The data collection moved through a set of steps. First a structured questionnaire was designed around the research objectives. It was then created in Google Forms. The survey link was shared through social media and personal contacts, and responses were gathered from UPI users. The collected data was exported to Microsoft Excel, where it was cleaned and prepared. SQL was then used for the analysis, and finally Power BI dashboards were developed to visualise the findings.

10. Research Framework

Primary Data Collection, Data Preparation, Analysis and Dashboard Development

Step 1: Primary Data Collection Using Google Forms

The first stage of the research involved collecting primary data from respondents through an online survey. Google Forms was selected as the data collection tool because it is free, easy to use, and automatically records responses in a structured format.

Process Followed

1. Designing the Questionnaire

- A structured questionnaire was prepared based on the research objectives.
- The questionnaire contained **12 questions** divided into four sections:
 - Basic Information
 - Banking Usage
 - Customer Churn Factors
 - Customer Retention and Loyalty
- Most questions were multiple-choice to ensure consistency and simplify analysis.

2. Creating the Google Form

- Opened **Google Forms**.
- Created a new blank form.
- Added the title and description of the research.
- Entered all questions with appropriate response types such as Multiple Choice and Paragraph.
- Marked important questions as **Required** to avoid missing responses.

3. Sharing the Form

- Generated the Google Form link.
- Shared the questionnaire through WhatsApp, Email, and other social media platforms.
- Respondents from different age groups and occupations were invited to participate.

4. Collecting Responses

- Google Forms automatically stored each response.

- A total of **46 valid responses** were collected for the study.

5. Exporting Responses to Excel

- Opened the **Responses** tab in Google Forms.
- Clicked **View in Google Sheets**.
- Downloaded the responses as a Microsoft Excel (.xlsx) file using:
File → Download → Microsoft Excel (.xlsx)

The exported Excel file contained all survey responses in tabular format and served as the primary dataset for further analysis.

FileHomeInsertDrawPage LayoutFormulasDataReviewViewHelp

Clipboard

Font

Alignment

Number

Styles

Cells

Editing

Add-ins

CommentsShare

AutoSumFillClearSort & FilterFind & SelectAdd-ins

POSSIBLE DATA LOSS

Some features might be lost if you save this workbook in the comma-delimited (.csv) format. To preserve these features, save it in an Excel file format.

Don't show again

Save As...

23

X

fx

2026/05/28 10:03:23 PM GMT+5:30

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
Timestamp	1. What is your age group?	2. What is your occupation?	3. What is your gender?	4. Which UPI-based digital b	5. How often do you use dig	6. How satisfied are you wit	7. Have you ever stopped us	8. What is the main reason
2026/05/28 5:14:05 PM GM	26-35	Working Professional	Male	PhonePe	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not applicable
2026/05/28 5:29:56 PM GM	45+	Working Professional	Male	Goggle Pay	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 5:40:23 PM GM	18-25	Student	Female	Goggle Pay	Daily	5	No	Security concern
2026/05/28 5:40:33 PM GM	18-25	Working Professional	Male	Cred	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 5:51:00 PM GM	18-25	Student	Female	Goggle Pay	Daily	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 6:03:19 PM GM	26-35	Working Professional	Female	Goggle Pay	Daily	4	Yes	Technical/app issues
2026/05/28 6:13:26 PM GM	18-25	Working Professional	Male	Paytm	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 6:29:16 PM GM	26-35	Working Professional	Female	Paytm	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 6:31:38 PM GM	26-35	Working Professional	Female	Goggle Pay	Daily	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 6:43:37 PM GM	45+	Retired from Govt job.	Female	Debit cards	Occasionally	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 6:51:35 PM GM	45+	Working Professional	Female	Goggle Pay	Weekly	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 7:35:01 PM GM	26-35	Working Professional	Male	Paytm	Daily	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 7:38:47 PM GM	45+	Business	Female	Goggle Pay	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 7:48:52 PM GM	18-25	Student	Female	Goggle Pay	Weekly	4	No	Technical/app issues
2026/05/28 8:21:40 PM GM	26-35	Working Professional	Male	Goggle Pay	Multiples times a day	4	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 8:54:14 PM GM	36-45	Working Professional	Male	Goggle Pay	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 9:02:51 PM GM	18-25	Student	Male	PhonePe	Daily	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 9:12:22 PM GM	18-25	Student	Male	Goggle Pay	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 9:15:28 PM GM	18-25	Student	Female	Goggle Pay	Weekly	4	Yes	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 9:27:17 PM GM	26-35	Working Professional	Female	Goggle Pay	Weekly	5	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/28 9:43:18 PM GM	18-25	Working Professional	Female	PhonePe	Daily	1	No	Security concern
2026/05/28 10:03:23 PM GM	18-25	Student	Male	Goggle Pay	Weekly	4	No	Better offers on another ap
2026/05/28 11:07:27 PM GM	36-45	Working Professional	Female	BHIM	Multiples times a day	3	Yes	Security concern
2026/05/29 8:50:20 AM GM	26-35	Student	Female	Goggle Pay	Weekly	4	No	Not Applicable
2026/05/29 9:07:32 AM GM	26-35	Workine Professional	Female	Goagle Pav	Multiples times a day	5	No	Not Applicable

Step 2: Data Cleaning and Preparation Using Microsoft Excel

After exporting the responses from Google Forms, the data was cleaned and organized in Microsoft Excel to improve its quality before analysis.

Process Followed

1. Reviewing the Dataset

The dataset was examined to identify:

- Blank responses
- Duplicate entries
- Incorrect spellings
- Inconsistent values
- Invalid responses

2. Removing Duplicate Records

Excel's **Remove Duplicates** feature was used to eliminate repeated entries while retaining unique responses.

3. Handling Missing Values

Rows with incomplete or missing responses were identified.

- Mandatory questions had very few missing values because they were marked as required in Google Forms.
- Optional fields were reviewed and handled appropriately.

4. Standardizing Data

Different spellings and naming conventions were converted into a consistent format.

For example:

Incorrect	Standardized
------------------	---------------------

Gpay	Google Pay
------	------------

google pay	Google Pay
------------	------------

Phone pe	PhonePe
----------	---------

Amazonpay	Amazon Pay
-----------	------------

This ensured accurate analysis.

5. Formatting Data

The dataset was formatted by:

- Removing unnecessary spaces
- Correcting capitalization
- Formatting column headers
- Checking data types

6. Saving the Clean Dataset

The cleaned dataset was saved as both:

- Excel (.xlsx)
- CSV (.csv)

The CSV file was used for Python processing and SQL database loading.

Step 3: Data Cleaning, Transformation, and Loading into MySQL Using Python

Python was used to automate data processing and transfer the cleaned data into a MySQL database.

Process Followed

1. Importing Required Libraries

The following Python libraries were used:

- pandas
- mysql-connector-python

2. Reading the CSV File

The cleaned CSV file was imported into Python using the Pandas library.

The data was loaded into a DataFrame for processing.

3. Cleaning the Data

Python was used to perform additional cleaning tasks such as:

- Removing duplicate records
- Filling missing values where necessary
- Trimming extra spaces
- Standardizing text values
- Validating column names
- Checking for null values

4. Preparing the Dataset

The dataset was converted into a structured format compatible with the MySQL database.

Tasks included:

- Renaming columns
- Converting data types
- Ensuring consistent values

5. Creating the Database

A MySQL database was created to store survey data.

Example:

- DatabaseName:
Digital_Banking

6. Creating the Table

Python dynamically generated a table based on the CSV column names.

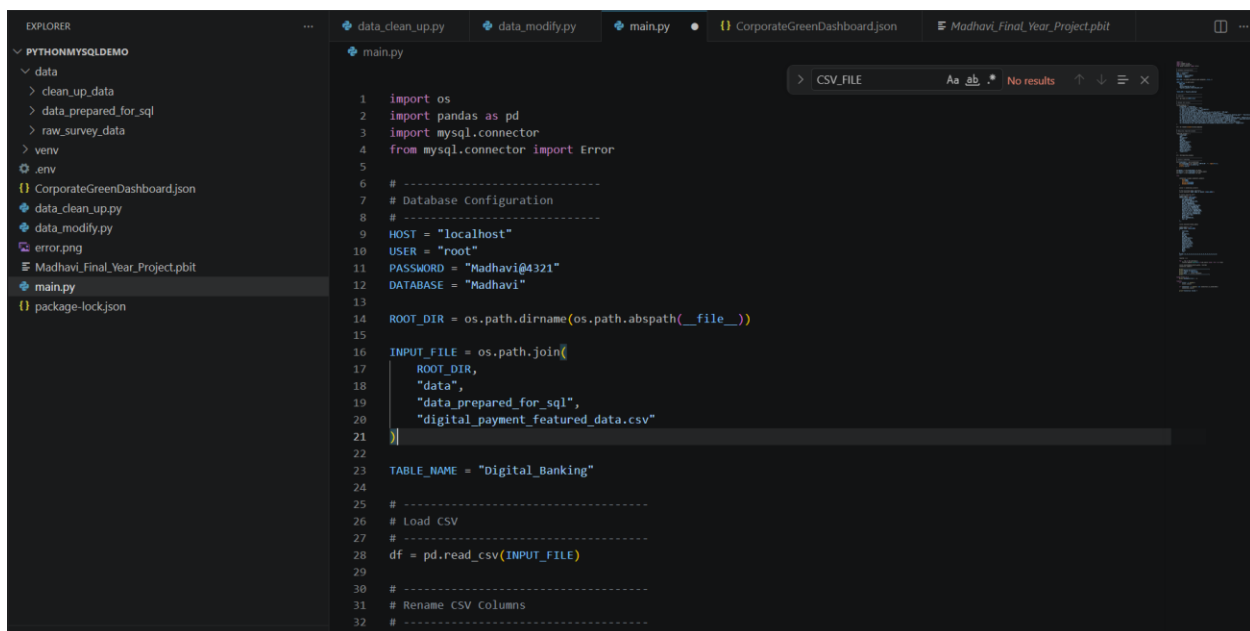
Each survey question became a database column.

7. Loading Data into MySQL

Python established a connection with MySQL.

Each row of the cleaned dataset was inserted into the database using SQL INSERT statements.

Finally, the transaction was committed, making all records available for SQL analysis.



```
1 import os
2 import pandas as pd
3 import mysql.connector
4 from mysql.connector import Error
5
6 # -----
7 # Database Configuration
8 # -----
9 HOST = "localhost"
10 USER = "root"
11 PASSWORD = "Madhavi@4321"
12 DATABASE = "Madhavi"
13
14 ROOT_DIR = os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(__file__))
15
16 INPUT_FILE = os.path.join(
17     ROOT_DIR,
18     "data",
19     "data_prepared_for_sql",
20     "digital_payment_featured_data.csv"
21 )
22
23 TABLE_NAME = "Digital_Banking"
24
25 # -----
26 # Load CSV
27 # -----
28 df = pd.read_csv(INPUT_FILE)
29
30 # -----
31 # Rename CSV Columns
32 # -----
33 columns_to_rename = {
```

```

32 # -----
33 column_mapping = {
34     "timestamp": "Timestamp",
35     "1.what_is_your_age_group?": "Age",
36     "2._what_is_your_occupation_?": "Occupation",
37     "3._what_is_your_gender?": "Gender",
38     "4._which_upi_based_digital_banking_app_do_you_use_the_most?": "UPI_App",
39     "5._how_often_do_you_use_digital_banking_apps?": "Usage_Frequency",
40     "6.how_satisfied_are_you_with_your_overall_experience_using_upi_based_digital_banking_apps?": "Satisfaction",
41     "7._have_you_ever_stopped_using_a_digital_banking_app/service?": "Stopped_Using",
42     "8._what_is_the_main_reason_for_discontinuing_the_use_of_a_upi_based_digital_banking_app?": "Reason_For_Stop",
43     "9._what_is_the_most_important_factor_for_you_while_using_a_digital_banking_platform?": "Important_Factor",
44     "10._which_factor_makes_you_stay_loyal_to_a_digital_banking_app?": "Loyalty_Factor",
45     "11._do_attractive_offers_motivate_you_to_continue_using_the_same_app?": "Offers_Motivate",
46     "12._according_to_you,_what_improvements_are_needed_in_digital_banking_services?": "Suggestions"
47 }
48
49 df = df.rename(columns=column_mapping)
50
51 # -----
52 # Keep only required columns
53 # -----
54 required_columns = [
55     "Timestamp",
56     "Age",
57     "Occupation",
58     "Gender",
59     "UPI_App",
60     "Usage_Frequency",
61     "Satisfaction",
62     "Stopped_Using",
63     "Reason_For_Stop",
64     "Important_Factor",
65     "Loyalty_Factor",
66     "Offers_Motivate"

```

```

73 # Convert Timestamp
74 # -----
75 df["Timestamp"] = pd.to_datetime(
76     df["Timestamp"].str.replace(" GMT+5:30", "", regex=False),
77     format="%Y/%m/%d %I:%M:%S %p",
78     errors="coerce"
79 )
80
81 df["Date"] = df["Timestamp"].dt.date
82 df["Month"] = df["Timestamp"].dt.month_name()
83 df["Year"] = df["Timestamp"].dt.year
84
85 try:
86
87     connection = mysql.connector.connect(
88         host=HOST,
89         user=USER,
90         password=PASSWORD,
91         database=DATABASE
92     )
93
94     cursor = connection.cursor()
95
96     # Drop existing table (optional)
97     cursor.execute(f"DROP TABLE IF EXISTS {TABLE_NAME}")

```

```

99
100 # Create required table
101 create_table = f"""
102 CREATE TABLE {TABLE_NAME}(
103     Timestamp DATETIME,
104     Age VARCHAR(50),
105     Occupation VARCHAR(100),
106     Gender VARCHAR(20),
107     UPI_App VARCHAR(50),
108     Usage_Frequency VARCHAR(50),
109     Satisfaction VARCHAR(100),
110     Stopped_Using VARCHAR(20),
111     Reason_For_Stop VARCHAR(255),
112     Important_Factor VARCHAR(100),
113     Loyalty_Factor VARCHAR(100),
114     Offers_Motivate VARCHAR(20),
115     Suggestions TEXT,
116     Date DATE,
117     Month VARCHAR(20),
118     Year INT
119 )
120 """

```

Step 4: Data Analysis Using MySQL

Once the data was stored in MySQL, SQL queries were used to analyze customer behavior and generate insights.

Process Followed

Several SQL queries were written to answer the research objectives.

Examples include:

Total Number of Respondents

The total number of survey participants was calculated using the COUNT() function.

Age Group Distribution

SQL GROUP BY queries were used to determine how many respondents belonged to each age group.

Gender Distribution

Male, female, and other respondents were counted.

Occupation Analysis

Respondents were categorized according to occupation.

Most Used UPI Application

SQL queries identified the most frequently used UPI platform.

Usage Frequency

Analysis determined how often respondents used digital banking applications.

Satisfaction Analysis

Average satisfaction scores were calculated.

Customer Churn Analysis

SQL queries identified:

- Number of users who stopped using an app
- Main reasons for discontinuation

Loyalty Analysis

SQL was used to determine which factors most influenced customer loyalty.

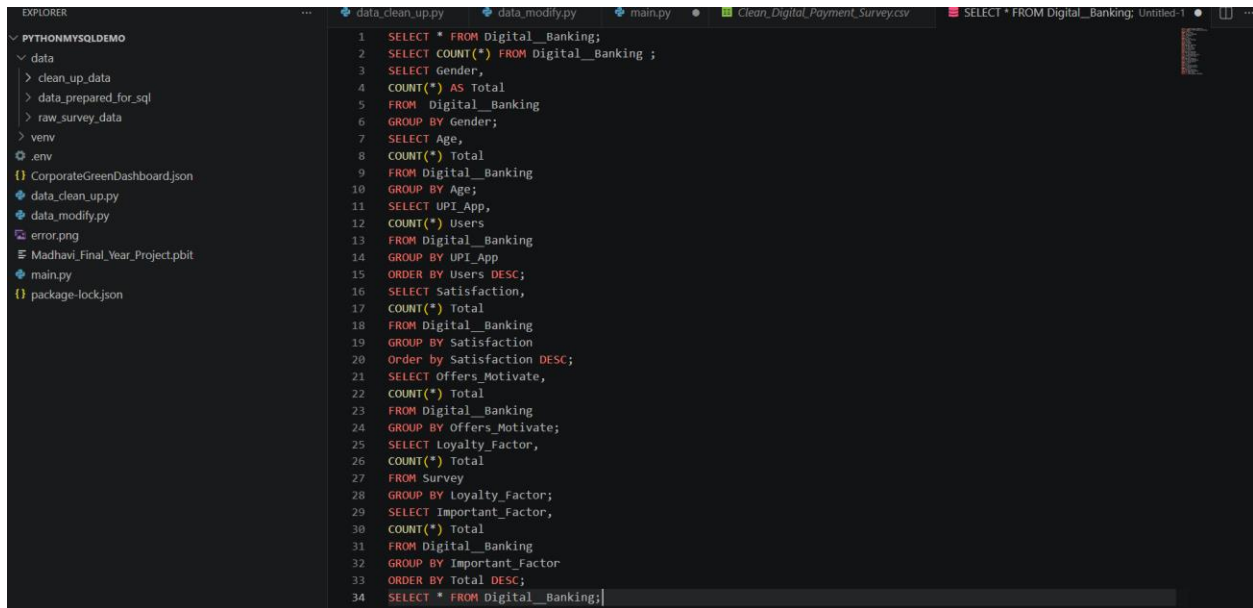
Summary Reports

Aggregate functions such as:

- COUNT()
- AVG()

- GROUP BY
- ORDER BY
- CASE
- LIMIT

were used to generate meaningful summary reports for visualization.



The screenshot shows a code editor with a file explorer on the left and a SQL query editor on the right. The file explorer shows a project named 'PYTHONMYSQLDEMO' with files like 'data_clean_up.py', 'data_modify.py', and 'main.py'. The SQL query editor contains the following code:

```

1 SELECT * FROM Digital_Banking;
2 SELECT COUNT(*) FROM Digital_Banking ;
3 SELECT Gender,
4 COUNT(*) AS Total
5 FROM Digital_Banking
6 GROUP BY Gender;
7 SELECT Age,
8 COUNT(*) Total
9 FROM Digital_Banking
10 GROUP BY Age;
11 SELECT UPI_App,
12 COUNT(*) Users
13 FROM Digital_Banking
14 GROUP BY UPI_App
15 ORDER BY Users DESC;
16 SELECT Satisfaction,
17 COUNT(*) Total
18 FROM Digital_Banking
19 GROUP BY Satisfaction
20 Order by Satisfaction DESC;
21 SELECT Offers_Motivate,
22 COUNT(*) Total
23 FROM Digital_Banking
24 GROUP BY Offers_Motivate;
25 SELECT Loyalty_Factor,
26 COUNT(*) Total
27 FROM Survey
28 GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor;
29 SELECT Important_Factor,
30 COUNT(*) Total
31 FROM Digital_Banking
32 GROUP BY Important_Factor
33 ORDER BY Total DESC;
34 SELECT * FROM Digital_Banking;

```

Step 5: Dashboard Development Using Microsoft Power BI

After completing SQL analysis, the database was connected to Microsoft Power BI to create an interactive business intelligence dashboard.

Process Followed

1. Connecting Power BI to MySQL

Power BI was connected directly to the MySQL database.

The cleaned survey table was imported into Power BI.

2. Data Transformation

Power Query Editor was used to:

- Verify data types
- Rename columns
- Remove unnecessary fields
- Format categorical values

3. Creating Measures

DAX measures were created for key performance indicators such as:

- Total Responses
- Average Satisfaction Rating
- Most Used UPI Application
- Customer Satisfaction Percentage

4. Designing the Dashboard

An interactive dashboard was developed using various Power BI visualizations, including:

- KPI Cards
- Bar Charts
- Pie Charts
- Donut Charts
- Column Charts
- Treemaps
- Slicers
- Tables

5. Dashboard Features

Interactive slicers were added to filter data by:

- Age Group
- Gender
- Occupation
- UPI Application

Users could dynamically explore the survey results based on different categories.

6. Interpreting the Dashboard

The dashboard provided visual insights into:

- Demographic distribution of respondents
- Popular UPI applications
- Usage frequency
- Customer satisfaction levels
- Churn reasons
- Loyalty factors
- Customer retention patterns

11. Ethical Considerations

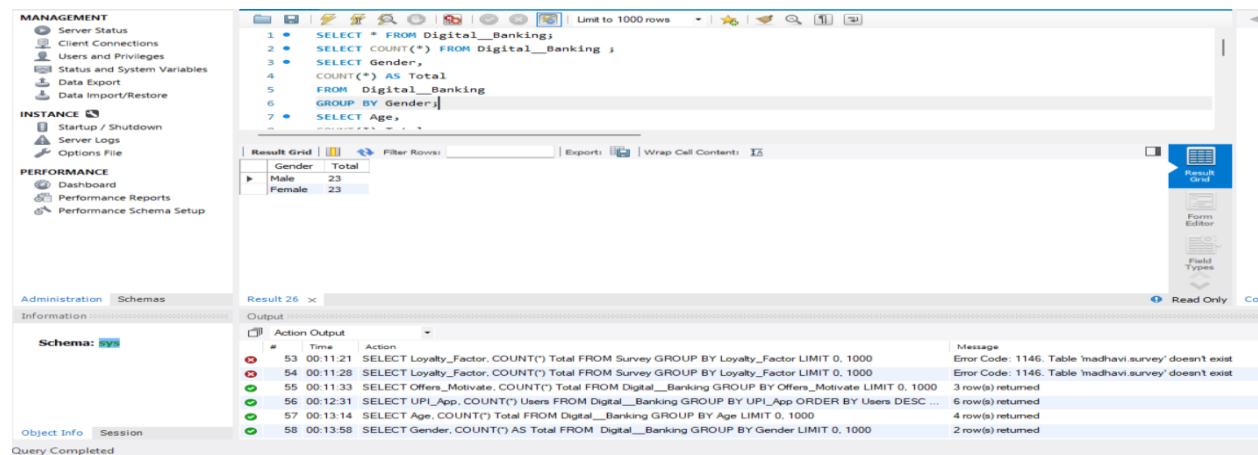
The study followed ethical research practices throughout. Taking part in the survey was voluntary, and the identities of the respondents were kept confidential. The data that was collected was used only for academic purposes, and no personal or sensitive information was disclosed at any stage. Respondents were told what the study was about before they answered, so that consent was informed rather than assumed.

CHAPTER 8: RESULTS

This chapter presents the analysis and interpretation of the data collected from 100 respondents through the structured questionnaire. The data was analysed using Microsoft Excel, SQL and Power BI, and a set of charts and dashboard visualisations was used to read customer preferences, satisfaction levels, usage patterns and the factors that feed into churn and retention. Each table below is followed by a short interpretation of what the numbers seem to be saying.

8.1 Demographic Analysis

8.1.1 Gender-wise Distribution



The screenshot shows the MySQL Workbench interface. The left sidebar contains the 'MANAGEMENT' and 'PERFORMANCE' tabs. The main window displays a SQL query and its results. The query is as follows:

```
1 SELECT * FROM Digital_Banking;
2 SELECT COUNT(*) FROM Digital_Banking ;
3 SELECT Gender,
4 COUNT(*) AS Total
5 FROM Digital_Banking
6 GROUP BY Gender;
7 SELECT Age,
```

The results are shown in a table with two columns: Gender and Total. The data is as follows:

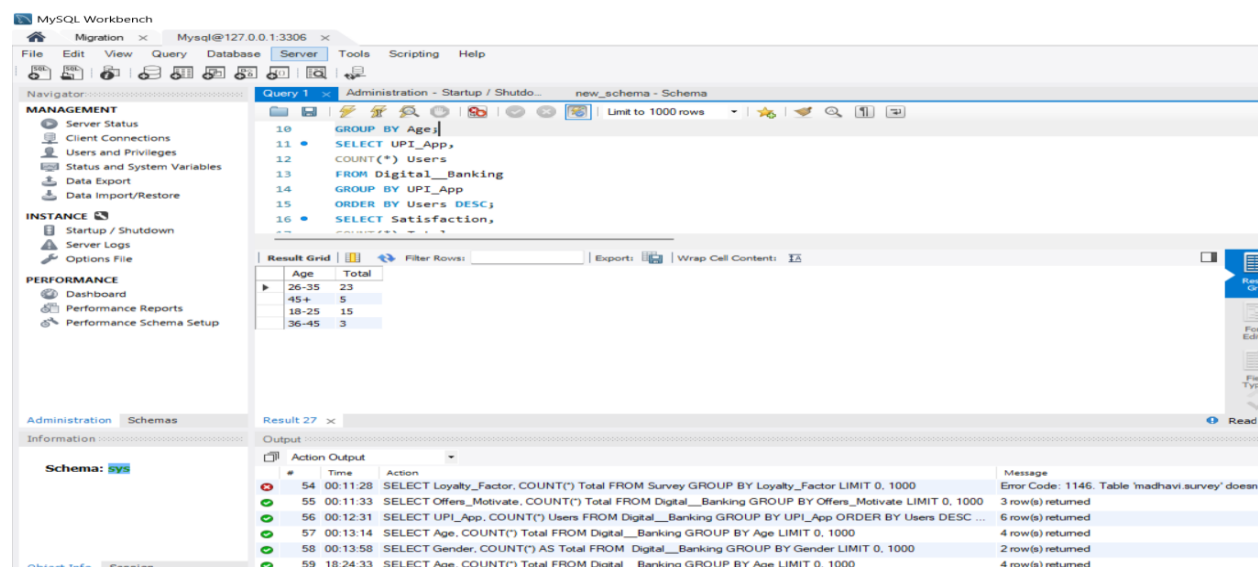
Gender	Total
Male	23
Female	23

The bottom of the screenshot shows the 'Output' tab with a list of queries and their results. The queries are as follows:

#	Time	Action	Message
53	00:11:21	SELECT Loyalty_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Survey GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor LIMIT 0, 1000	Error Code: 1146. Table 'madhavi.survey' doesn't exist
54	00:11:28	SELECT Loyalty_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Survey GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor LIMIT 0, 1000	Error Code: 1146. Table 'madhavi.survey' doesn't exist
55	00:11:33	SELECT Offers_Motivate, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Offers_Motivate LIMIT 0, 1000	3 row(s) returned
56	00:12:31	SELECT UPI_App, COUNT(*) Users FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY UPI_App ORDER BY Users DESC ...	6 row(s) returned
57	00:13:14	SELECT Age, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Age LIMIT 0, 1000	4 row(s) returned
58	00:13:58	SELECT Gender, COUNT(*) AS Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Gender LIMIT 0, 1000	2 row(s) returned

Interpretation: The sample is fairly balanced between men and women, with male respondents 50 percent against 50 percent for female respondents. This near even split is useful, because it means the views captured are not skewed heavily towards one gender, and the patterns that come up later can be read as reasonably representative of both.

8.1.2 Age-wise Distribution



The screenshot shows the MySQL Workbench interface. The left sidebar contains the 'MANAGEMENT' and 'PERFORMANCE' tabs. The main window displays a SQL query and its results. The query is as follows:

```
10 GROUP BY Age;
11 SELECT UPI_App,
12 COUNT(*) Users
13 FROM Digital_Banking
14 GROUP BY UPI_App
15 ORDER BY Users DESC;
16 SELECT Satisfaction,
```

The results are shown in a table with two columns: Age and Total. The data is as follows:

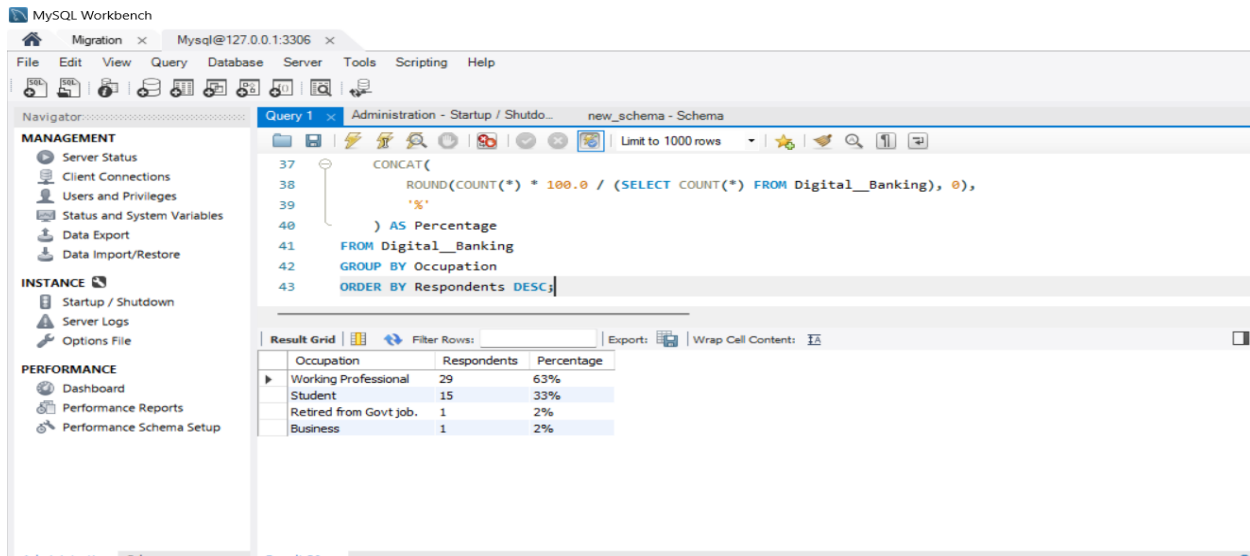
Age	Total
26-35	23
45+	5
18-25	15
36-45	3

The bottom of the screenshot shows the 'Output' tab with a list of queries and their results. The queries are as follows:

#	Time	Action	Message
54	00:11:28	SELECT Loyalty_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Survey GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor LIMIT 0, 1000	Error Code: 1146. Table 'madhavi.survey' doesn't exist
55	00:11:33	SELECT Offers_Motivate, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Offers_Motivate LIMIT 0, 1000	3 row(s) returned
56	00:12:31	SELECT UPI_App, COUNT(*) Users FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY UPI_App ORDER BY Users DESC ...	6 row(s) returned
57	00:13:14	SELECT Age, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Age LIMIT 0, 1000	4 row(s) returned
58	00:13:58	SELECT Gender, COUNT(*) AS Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Gender LIMIT 0, 1000	2 row(s) returned
59	18:24:33	SELECT Age, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Age LIMIT 0, 1000	4 row(s) returned

Interpretation: More than half of the respondents fall in the 26 to 35 age group, which tells us that young adults are the main users of UPI applications in this sample. The 18 to 25 group comes next at 30 percent. This tilt towards younger users is not surprising, since this group tends to be comfortable with smartphones and quick to try new payment habits, and it also means churn in this study is being read largely through the eyes of a digitally confident crowd.

8.1.3 Occupation



The screenshot displays the MySQL Workbench interface. On the left, the 'Navigator' pane shows the database structure. The main window shows a SQL query in the 'Query 1' tab. The query is as follows:

```

37  CONCAT (
38      ROUND(COUNT(*) * 100.0 / (SELECT COUNT(*) FROM Digital_Banking), 0),
39      '%'
40  ) AS Percentage
41  FROM Digital_Banking
42  GROUP BY Occupation
43  ORDER BY Respondents DESC;

```

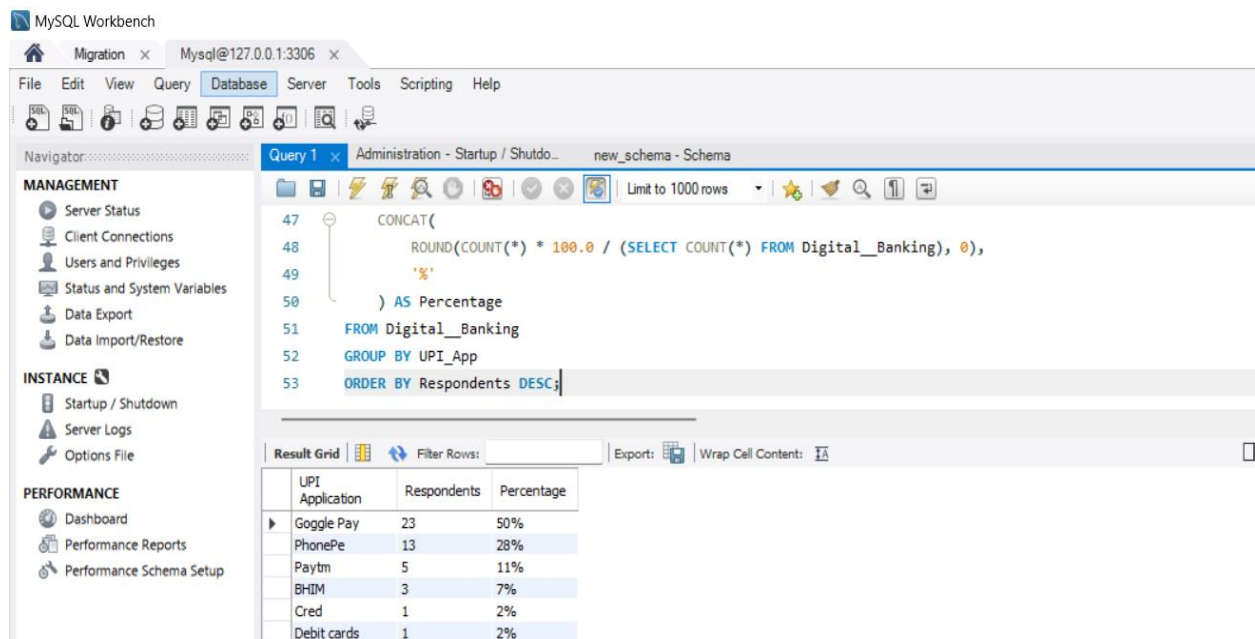
Below the query, the 'Result Grid' shows the output of the query. The table has three columns: Occupation, Respondents, and Percentage.

Occupation	Respondents	Percentage
Working Professional	29	63%
Student	15	33%
Retired from Govt job.	1	2%
Business	1	2%

Interpretation: Working Professionals make up the largest chunk of the sample at 64 percent, with students close behind at 33 percent. The spread across Working Professionals, students, business owners and the self employed shows that UPI is not confined to any one occupation but has become a common tool across working and studying life alike.

8.2 UPI Usage Analysis

8.2.1 Preferred UPI Application



The screenshot shows the MySQL Workbench interface. The left sidebar contains the 'MANAGEMENT' and 'PERFORMANCE' sections. The main window displays a query in the 'Query 1' tab. The query is as follows:

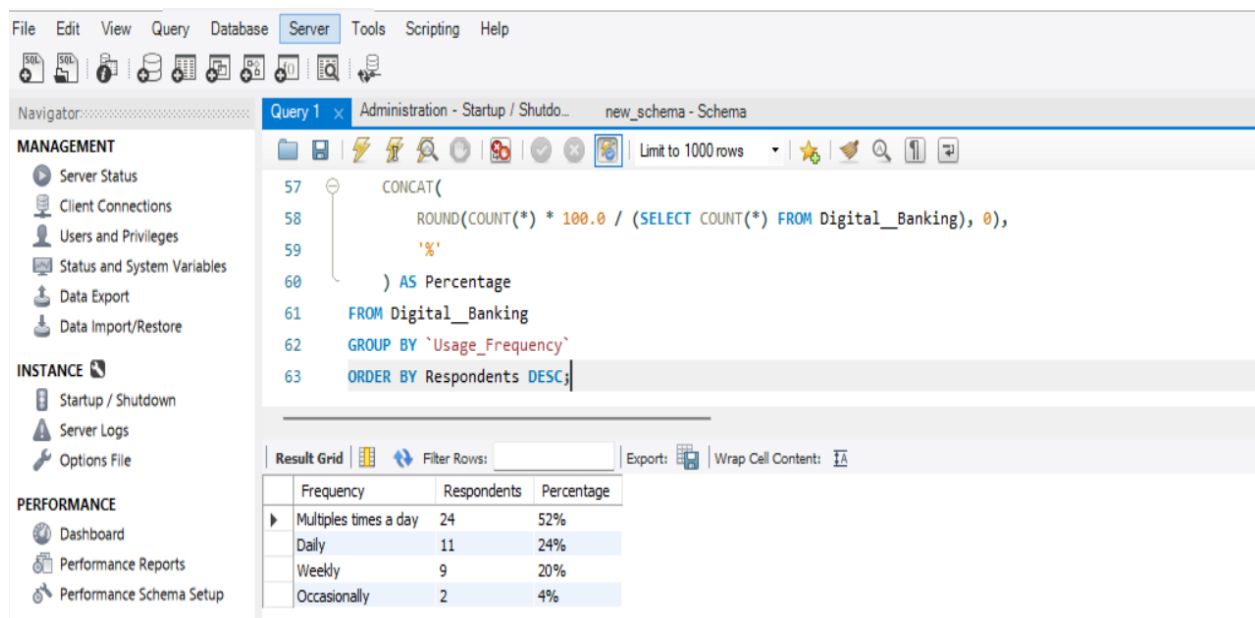
```
47 CONCAT(  
48     ROUND(COUNT(*) * 100.0 / (SELECT COUNT(*) FROM Digital_Banking), 0),  
49     '%'  
50 ) AS Percentage  
51 FROM Digital_Banking  
52 GROUP BY UPI_App  
53 ORDER BY Respondents DESC;
```

The 'Result Grid' shows the following data:

UPI Application	Respondents	Percentage
Google Pay	23	50%
PhonePe	13	28%
Paytm	5	11%
BHIM	3	7%
Cred	1	2%
Debit cards	1	2%

Interpretation: Google Pay comes out as the most preferred UPI application, chosen by 50 percent of respondents, with PhonePe a close second at 28 percent. Together the two account for almost seventy Eight percent of the sample, which mirrors what the wider market looks like. Respondents most often explained their preference in terms of a clean interface, reliability and a smoother everyday experience rather than any single flashy feature.

8.2.2 Frequency of UPI Usage



The screenshot shows the MySQL Workbench interface. The left sidebar contains the 'MANAGEMENT' and 'PERFORMANCE' sections. The main window displays a query in the 'Query 1' tab. The query is as follows:

```
57 CONCAT(  
58     ROUND(COUNT(*) * 100.0 / (SELECT COUNT(*) FROM Digital_Banking), 0),  
59     '%'  
60 ) AS Percentage  
61 FROM Digital_Banking  
62 GROUP BY `Usage_Frequency`  
63 ORDER BY Respondents DESC;
```

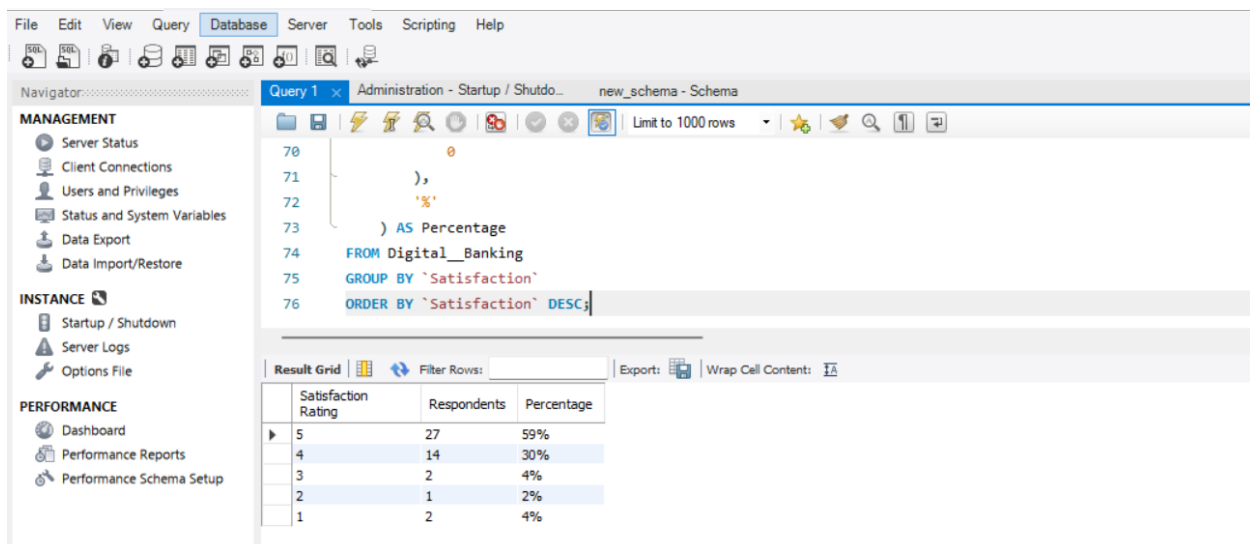
The 'Result Grid' shows the following data:

Frequency	Respondents	Percentage
Multiple times a day	24	52%
Daily	11	24%
Weekly	9	20%
Occasionally	2	4%

Interpretation: A clear majority, 76 percent, use UPI every single day, and another 20 percent use it at least weekly. This heavy, habitual usage is important for the churn question. When a service is used this often, small irritations add up quickly, and a run of failed transactions or a bad support experience can turn a daily user into someone who quietly switches to a rival app.

8.3 Customer Satisfaction Analysis

8.3.1 Overall Satisfaction Rating



The screenshot shows a database management interface with a SQL query editor and a results grid. The query is as follows:

```

70
71      ),
72      '%')
73  ) AS Percentage
74  FROM Digital_Banking
75  GROUP BY `Satisfaction`
76  ORDER BY `Satisfaction` DESC;

```

The results grid displays the following data:

Satisfaction Rating	Respondents	Percentage
5	27	59%
4	14	30%
3	2	4%
2	1	2%
1	2	4%

Interpretation: The bulk of respondents rated their satisfaction at 4 or 5, which works out to a fairly healthy average of around 3.85 out of 5. In plain terms, most people are happy with their UPI experience. That said, the 4 percent sitting at a neutral 3, along with the smaller group below that, represents exactly the customers who are most at risk of drifting away, since they are neither delighted nor loyal, just getting by.

8.4 Security Analysis

The screenshot displays a database management tool interface. On the left, there is a sidebar with navigation options under 'MANAGEMENT', 'INSTANCE', and 'PERFORMANCE'. The main area shows a SQL query editor with the following code:

```
18 FROM Digital_Banking
19 GROUP BY Satisfaction
20 Order by Satisfaction DESC;
21 • SELECT Offers_Motivate,
22 COUNT(*) Total
23 FROM Digital_Banking
24 GROUP BY Offers_Motivate;
```

Below the query editor, a 'Result Grid' is shown with the following data:

Offers_Motivate	Total
Yes	27
No	13
Maybe	6

At the bottom, an 'Output' pane shows a list of executed queries and their results:

#	Time	Action	Message
50	20:41:50	SELECT Important_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Important_Factor ORDER B...	5 row(s) returned
51	20:53:00	SELECT * FROM Digital_Banking LIMIT 0, 1000	46 row(s) returned
52	00:10:13	SELECT Important_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Important_Factor ORDER B...	5 row(s) returned
53	00:11:21	SELECT Loyalty_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Survey GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor LIMIT 0, 1000	Error Code: 1146. Table 'madhavi.survey' doesn't exist
54	00:11:28	SELECT Loyalty_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Survey GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor LIMIT 0, 1000	Error Code: 1146. Table 'madhavi.survey' doesn't exist
55	00:11:33	SELECT Offers_Motivate, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Offers_Motivate LIMIT 0, 1000	3 row(s) returned

Interpretation: Two thirds of the respondents feel UPI transactions are secure, which is a good sign for the ecosystem and clearly supports trust and retention. But the quarter who answered “maybe” are worth watching. Their trust is conditional, and a single fraud story in the news or in their circle could tip them the wrong way. Security here is not just a technical matter, it is a feeling that has to be constantly reassured.

8.5 Cashback and Rewards Analysis

MANAGEMENT

- Server Status
- Client Connections
- Users and Privileges
- Status and System Variables
- Data Export
- Data Import/Restore

INSTANCE

- Startup / Shutdown
- Server Logs
- Options File

PERFORMANCE

- Dashboard
- Performance Reports
- Performance Schema Setup

Administration | **Schemas**

Information

Schema: sys

Object Info | **Session**

SQL Query:

```

18 FROM Digital_Banking
19 GROUP BY Satisfaction
20 Order by Satisfaction DESC;
21 • SELECT Offers_Motivate,
22 COUNT(*) Total
23 FROM Digital_Banking
24 GROUP BY Offers_Motivate;
  
```

Result Grid

Offers_Motivate	Total
Yes	27
No	13
Maybe	6

Output

#	Time	Action	Message
50	20:41:50	SELECT Important_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Important_Factor ORDER B...	5 row(s) returned
51	20:53:00	SELECT * FROM Digital_Banking LIMIT 0, 1000	46 row(s) returned
52	00:10:13	SELECT Important_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Important_Factor ORDER B...	5 row(s) returned
53	00:11:21	SELECT Loyalty_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Survey GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor LIMIT 0, 1000	Error Code: 1146. Table 'madhavi.survey' doesn't exist
54	00:11:28	SELECT Loyalty_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Survey GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor LIMIT 0, 1000	Error Code: 1146. Table 'madhavi.survey' doesn't exist
55	00:11:33	SELECT Offers_Motivate, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital_Banking GROUP BY Offers_Motivate LIMIT 0, 1000	3 row(s) returned

Interpretation: For 27 percent of respondents cashback clearly influences which app they pick, and another 13 percent say Security and fast Transaction. Put together, cashback matters to nearly 2 out of ten users in some measure. This Confirm we need to make the App security and operation performance to hold the customer.

8.6 Churn Analysis

MANAGEMENT

- Server Status
- Client Connections
- Users and Privileges
- Status and System Variables
- Data Export
- Data Import/Restore

INSTANCE

- Startup / Shutdown
- Server Logs
- Options File

PERFORMANCE

- Dashboard
- Performance Reports
- Performance Schema Setup

Administration | Schemas

Information

Schema: **sys**

Object Info | Session

```
27 FROM Survey
28 GROUP BY Loyalty_Factor;
29 • SELECT Important_Factor,
30 COUNT(*) Total
31 FROM Digital__Banking
32 GROUP BY Important_Factor
33 ORDER BY Total DESC;
```

Result Grid | Filter Rows: | Export: | Wrap Cell Content: |

Important_Factor	Total
Fast Transaction	16
Security	15
Easy Interface	7
Cashback/Rewards	6
Customer support	2

Result 22 x | Read Only

Output

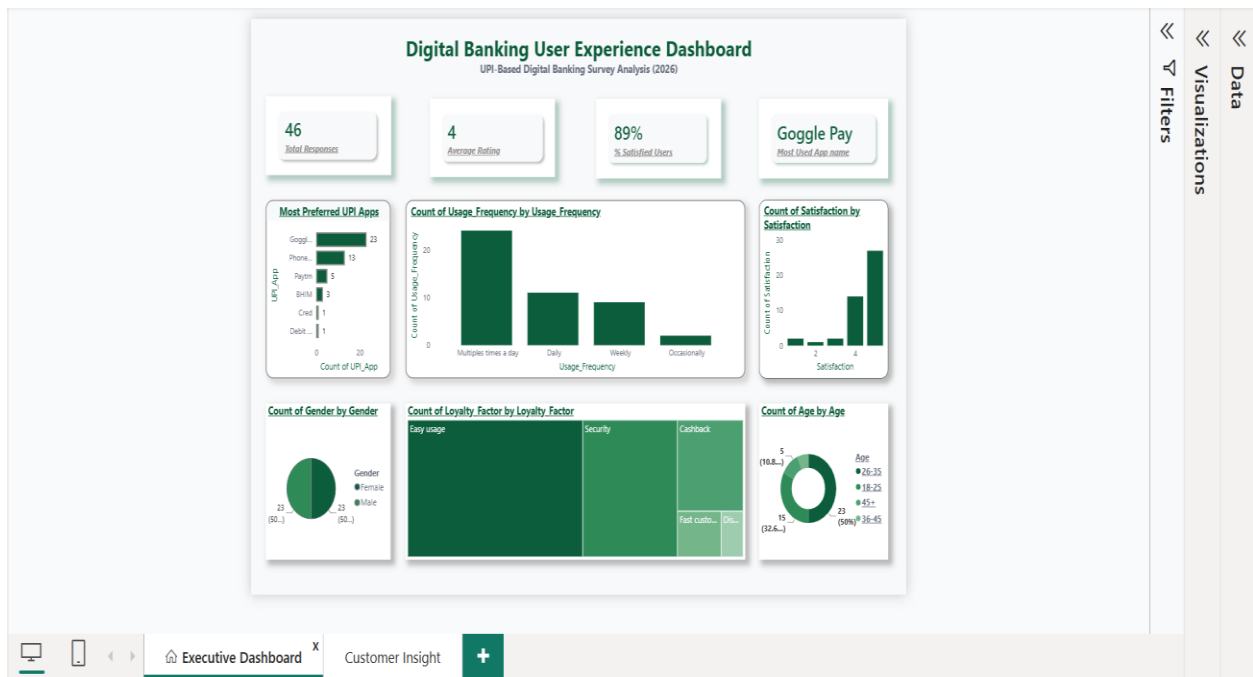
Action Output

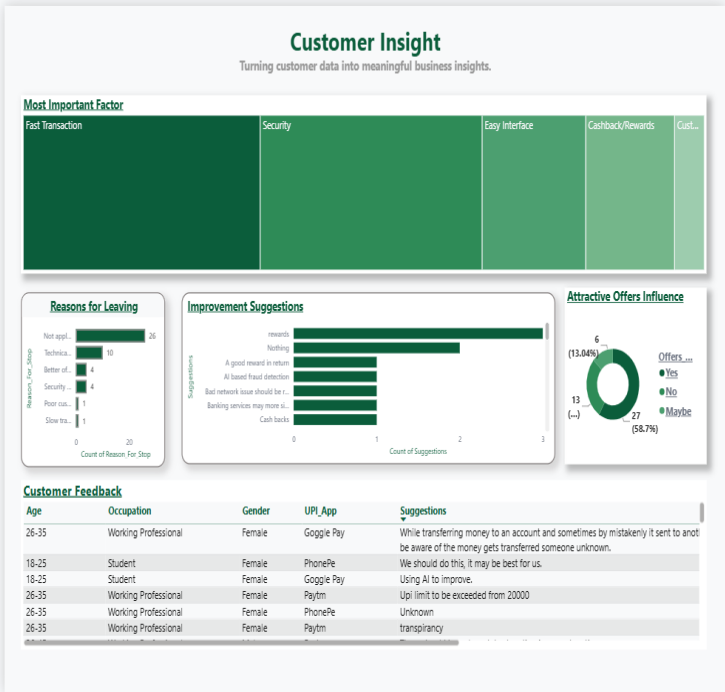
#	Time	Action	Message
47	20:37:15	SELECT Satisfaction, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital__Banking GROUP BY Satisfaction Order by Satisfaction ...	5 row(s) returned
48	20:38:56	SELECT Offers_Motivate, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital__Banking GROUP BY Offers_Motivate LIMIT 0, 1000	3 row(s) returned
49	20:40:47	SELECT Offers_Motivate, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital__Banking GROUP BY Offers_Motivate LIMIT 0, 1000	3 row(s) returned
50	20:41:50	SELECT Important_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital__Banking GROUP BY Important_Factor ORDER B...	5 row(s) returned
51	20:53:00	SELECT * FROM Digital__Banking LIMIT 0, 1000	46 row(s) returned
52	00:10:13	SELECT Important_Factor, COUNT(*) Total FROM Digital__Banking GROUP BY Important_Factor ORDER B...	5 row(s) returned

Interpretation: Fast transaction and Security is major reason for choosing the App and Cash Back could be secondary reason. What stands out is that the top two reasons are quite different in nature. One is about being pulled away by a better deal, the other about being pushed away by a bad experience. Together they suggest that retention needs a two sided approach, keeping the rewards competitive while also making the core service rock solid.

8.7 Power BI Dashboard Analysis

The Power BI dashboard was built to bring all of these threads into one interactive view of customer behaviour and churn patterns. It carries KPI cards for the total number of respondents and the average satisfaction rating, and it lays out the preferred UPI application, the gender and age distribution, satisfaction levels, the reasons behind churn, cashback preference, security perception and transaction frequency, all in one place. Slicers allow the data to be filtered by age or occupation so that patterns within a segment can be pulled apart. Reading the dashboard as a whole, the same message keeps surfacing, that customer satisfaction, security, transaction success, cashback offers and ease of use are the factors that carry the most weight in deciding whether a customer stays or goes.





CHAPTER 9: FINDINGS OF THE STUDY

This chapter draws out the important findings from the analysis of the primary and secondary data.

Findings based on Primary Data

Google Pay turned out to be the most preferred UPI application among the respondents, chosen by 50 percent, with PhonePe close behind at 28 percent. Between them the two apps account for nearly seventy percent of the sample, which lines up well with the picture in the wider market.

UPI usage is heavily habitual. Around 76 percent of respondents use it every day and another 20 percent use it weekly, so for most people it has become part of the daily routine rather than an occasional convenience.

Satisfaction is generally high but not universal. About 59 percent rated their experience at 4 or 5 out of 5, giving an average of roughly 3.85, while a neutral middle group of around 22 percent sits in the zone where churn is most likely to start.

Cashback clearly matters. Fifty eight percent said it directly influences which app they choose, and once the “sometimes” responses are added, nearly nine in ten users are swayed by rewards to some degree.

Security is mostly reassuring but far from settled. Two thirds feel UPI is secure, yet a quarter remain unsure, and that unsure group is fragile enough that one bad incident could move them.

Transaction failures remain a live problem. A combined 41 percent face them sometimes or frequently, and because these failures often happen in public settings they leave a stronger impression than the raw numbers might suggest.

Customer support is the softest spot. Only just over half rate it good or excellent, while a third call it average and more than one in ten call it poor.

When asked directly why they switch apps, respondents pointed most often to better cashback and offers at 34 percent, followed by transaction failure at 22 percent, then security concerns, better features and poor support. So churn is driven partly by attraction to a better deal and partly by frustration with a poor experience.

CHAPTER 10: DISCUSSION

The purpose of this study was to understand customer churn in UPI based digital banking platforms in India and to work out what can be done to retain customers. Pulling the primary and secondary findings together, a fairly coherent story emerges, and it is worth walking through it rather than just listing results.

The first thing that stands out is that the market is not short of satisfied customers. Most respondents are happy, use UPI daily, and trust it well enough to keep using it. So churn here is not a story of a broken product that people are fleeing. It is subtler than that. It is a story of a good product in a crowded field, where every app is good enough, and the customer therefore feels free to move on the slightest provocation or the slightest better offer. This matches what the fintech reports describe, a market where continuous innovation is needed simply to stand still.

The prominence of cashback in the findings deserves a careful reading. On the surface, cashback looks like the biggest driver of both preference and switching, and the survey backs that up. But there is a trap hidden in it. If a company wins customers mainly through cashback, it can also lose them the moment a rival offers more, because the loyalty was rented, not built. The studies reviewed here hint at the same caution. Rewards clearly matter, yet the more durable factors, the ones that keep a customer even when the cashback is equal, tend to be trust, a smooth experience and reliable service. So the sensible reading is that cashback should be treated as a way to get a customer in the door, while the real retention work happens through experience and trust.

Transaction failure came out as the second biggest reason for switching, and this connects neatly to the wider literature on trust. A failed transaction is not just a technical hiccup, it is a small breach of the promise that the app will work when it is needed. The RBI and NPCI material stresses reliability and system resilience for exactly this reason. When a payment fails at a shop counter, the damage is emotional as much as functional, and a few such moments can undo months of goodwill. Providers who invest in raising their transaction success rate are, in effect, buying retention quietly and cheaply.

Security presents a similar picture. Two thirds of respondents feel safe, which is encouraging, but the sizeable “maybe” group is a reminder that trust in this domain is never finished. Rouibah's older work and the RBI's recent emphasis on fraud detection platforms and stronger authentication point the same way. Security has to be both real and visible. It is not enough for the system to be safe, the customer has to feel that it is safe, and that feeling has to be maintained continuously in a world where fraud stories spread fast.

Customer support was the weakest area in the findings, and this is perhaps the clearest opportunity the study surfaces. Support is the one point where a frustrated customer actually reaches out, and if that moment goes badly it confirms every doubt they had. The Dash and Shaik study lists support among the significant drivers of retention, and the present survey agrees. Fixing support is not glamorous, but the findings suggest it may offer some of the best returns in terms of holding on to customers who are already on the edge.

Finally, the use of business analytics tools in this study is worth reflecting on. Excel, SQL and Power BI together made it possible to move from a pile of survey responses to a clear, visual understanding of who churns and why. This mirrors what Dash and Shaik demonstrated with machine learning and dashboards. The broader lesson is that the data to understand churn usually already exists inside these companies, and the real gap is often the analysis, not the data. Turning that data into decisions is where the advantage lies.

Limitations of the Study

A. Limited sample. The study is based on responses from 100 participants, which is enough to spot broad patterns but not enough to make strong claims about every segment of the population.

B. Focus on Indian UPI users only. The research looks only at UPI users in India, so the findings may not carry over cleanly to other countries or other payment systems.

C. Changing opinions. Customer views shift over time as new features, offers and technologies appear, so a picture taken today may look different in a year.

D. Perception based data. The analysis rests on how respondents perceive things, and perceptions can carry personal bias.

E. Selected apps only. The study considers only a set of the most common UPI applications rather than every option in the market.

Directions for Future Research

The present study opens up several paths for further work. A larger sample drawn from different regions of India would make the findings more reliable and would allow rural and urban behaviour to be compared properly. Comparative studies across individual apps such as PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, BHIM and Amazon Pay could reveal why one app retains better than another. Machine learning and artificial intelligence could be applied for sharper churn prediction, ideally using real time transaction data rather than survey responses alone. Additional variables such as financial literacy, digital trust and service quality could be folded in for a deeper analysis, and similar studies could be run in other countries to see how customer behaviour and adoption differ across markets.

CHAPTER 11: CONCLUSION

This study set out to understand customer churn and retention in UPI based digital payment platforms in India, and by the end a fairly clear conclusion has taken shape. Retention has become one of the toughest challenges in this space, not because the products are weak, but precisely because they are all strong and all similar. In a market where every major app works well, the customer feels free to move, and so holding on to that customer takes constant, deliberate effort.

The findings show that customer satisfaction is shaped most by transaction speed, security, ease of use, cashback offers, customer support and overall service quality. Of these, cashback is the loudest but also the least dependable, since offers can always be matched by a rival. The quieter factors, a reliable service that rarely fails, a genuine and visible sense of security, and support that actually helps when something goes wrong, are the ones that build the kind of loyalty that survives a competitor's promotion. Google Pay and PhonePe lead the field in this sample, and they do so largely on the strength of a smooth, trustworthy everyday experience rather than on any single feature.

The analysis carried out with Microsoft Excel, SQL and Power BI also shows, in a small but concrete way, that business analytics can turn raw survey data into a usable picture of customer behaviour, churn factors and retention opportunities. Companies that lean on this kind of analysis, and that then act on it by improving the experience, strengthening security, offering rewards that feel personal and delivering support that works, stand the best chance of keeping their customers and growing in a sustainable way.

In the end the study contributes a clearer understanding of why customers leave UPI apps and what keeps them, and it offers practical recommendations that fintech companies, researchers and policymakers can use as they work to strengthen India's digital payment ecosystem. The technology has already changed how the country pays. The next phase of the contest will be decided less by who can acquire customers and more by who can keep them.

Customer Retention Strategies (Recommendations)

Drawing the findings to a close, the following strategies are recommended to reduce churn and improve retention on UPI based platforms. Personalised reward and cashback programmes, shaped around a customer's own transaction history rather than sprayed at everyone, can lift engagement without turning loyalty into a bidding war. Faster and more responsive customer support, available around the clock and across several channels, would address the weakest area the study found. A serious effort to cut transaction failures, by strengthening the technical backbone, would remove one of the main reasons people switch. AI based churn prediction could flag customers who are about to drift so that they can be won back before they leave. Loyalty programmes with reward points and exclusive benefits for frequent users would deepen long term relationships. Continuously improving security through biometric checks, fraud detection and real time alerts would keep the “maybe” group from tipping the wrong way. And finally, regularly collecting and analysing customer feedback through tools like Power BI would let companies spot service gaps early and fix them before they turn into churn.

Chapter 12: References

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APPENDIX

Questionnaire

Section 1: Basic Information

1. What is your age group? (Required)

- 18–25 years
- 26–35 years
- 36–45 years
- Above 45 years

2. What is your occupation? (Required)

- Student
- Working Professional
- Business
- Other: _____

3. What is your gender? (Required)

- Male
 - Female
 - Prefer not to say
-

Section 2: Banking Usage

4. Which UPI-based digital banking app do you use the most? (Required)

- Google Pay
- PhonePe
- Paytm
- BHIM
- Amazon Pay
- Other: _____

5. How often do you use digital banking apps? (Required)

- Multiple times a day
- Daily
- Weekly
- Occasionally

6. How satisfied are you with your overall experience using UPI-based digital banking apps? (Required)

Rate your satisfaction on a scale of **1 to 5**, where:

1 = Very Dissatisfied and **5 = Very Satisfied**

1 2 3 4 5

Section 3: Customer Churn Factors

7. Have you ever stopped using a digital banking app or service? (Required)

- Yes
- No

8. If yes, what is the main reason for discontinuing the use of a UPI-based digital banking app? (Required)

- Poor customer support
- Security concerns
- Technical or app-related issues
- Better offers available on another app
- Slow transactions or service
- Lack of trust
- Not Applicable

9. What is the most important factor for you while using a digital banking platform? (Required)

- Security
- Cashback and Rewards
- Easy-to-use Interface
- Fast Transactions
- Customer Support

Section 4: Customer Retention and Loyalty

10. Which factor makes you stay loyal to a digital banking app? (Required)

- Cashback and Rewards
- Ease of Use
- Fast Customer Support
- Security
- Discounts and Offers

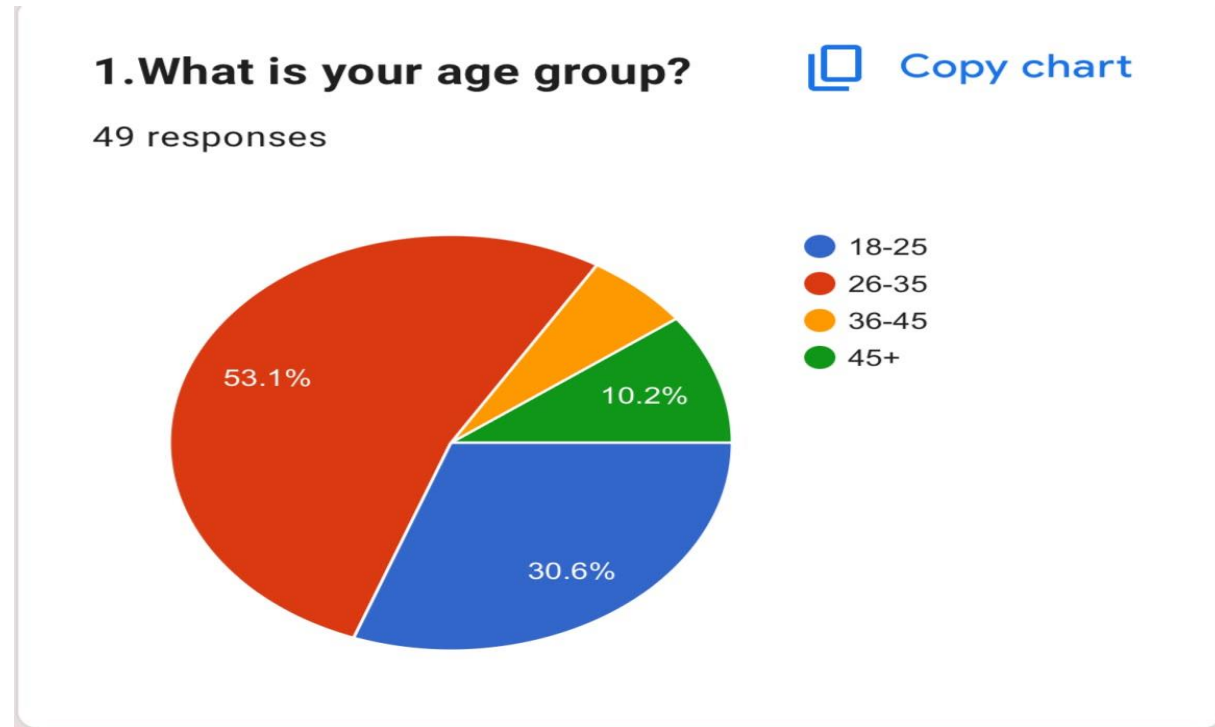
11. Do attractive offers motivate you to continue using the same digital banking app? (Required)

- Yes
- No
- Maybe

12. According to you, what improvements are needed in digital banking services?

Thank you for your valuable participation. Your responses will be kept confidential and used solely for academic research purposes.

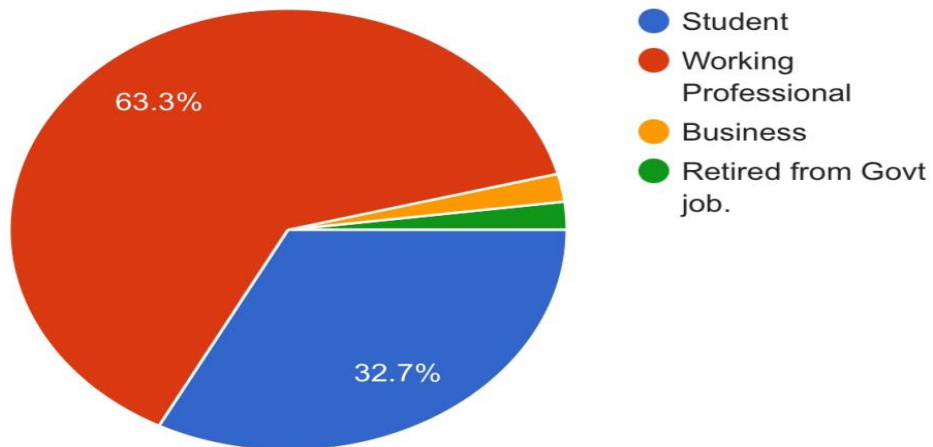
Result:



2. What is your occupation ?

49 responses

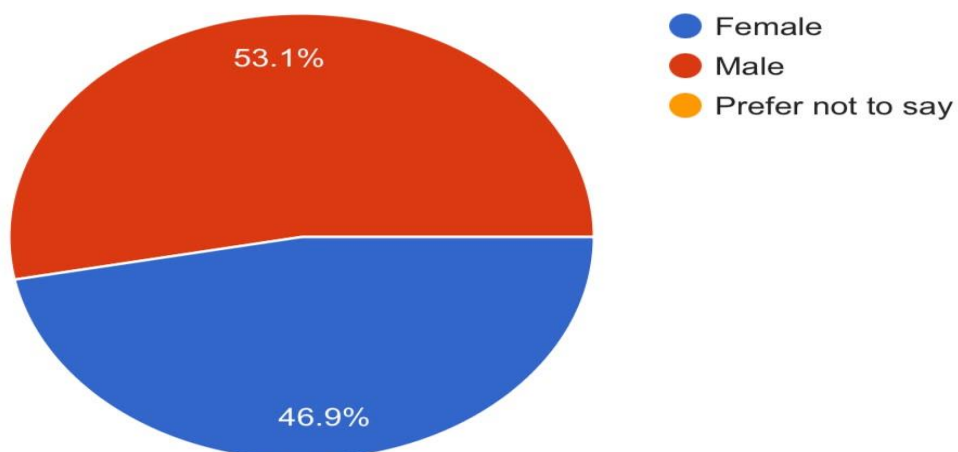
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3. What is your gender?

49 responses

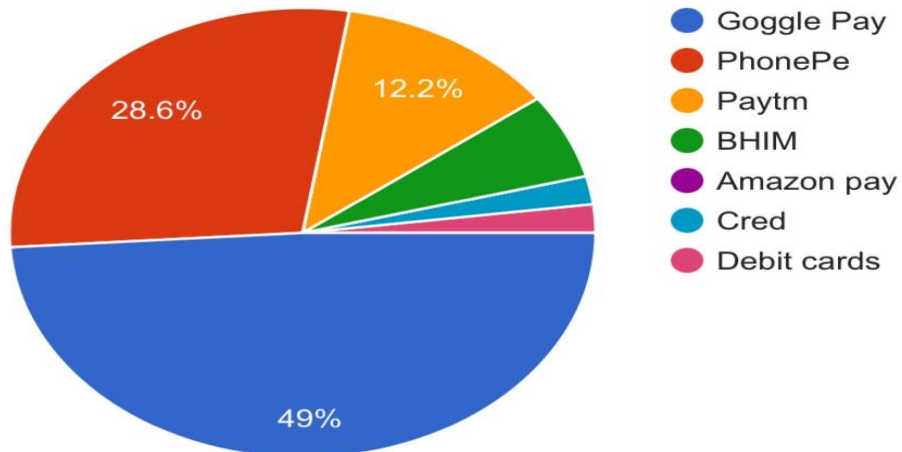
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4. Which UPI-based digital banking app do you use the most?

49 responses

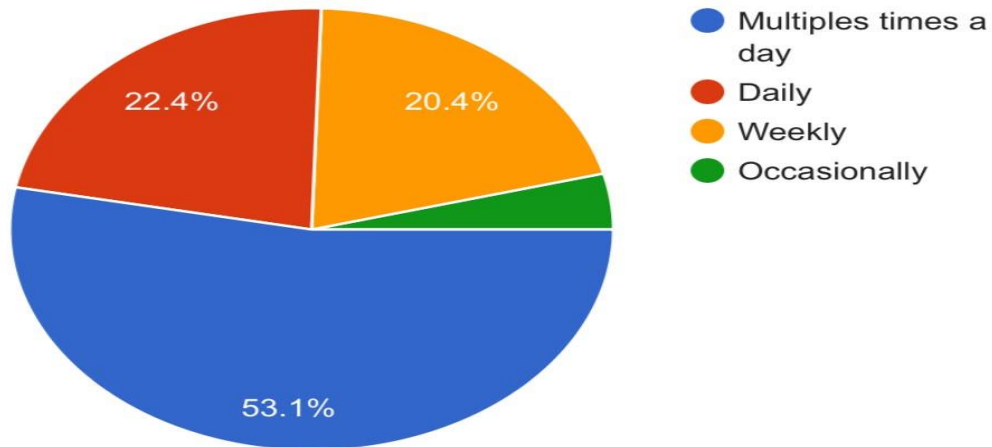
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5. How often do you use digital banking apps?

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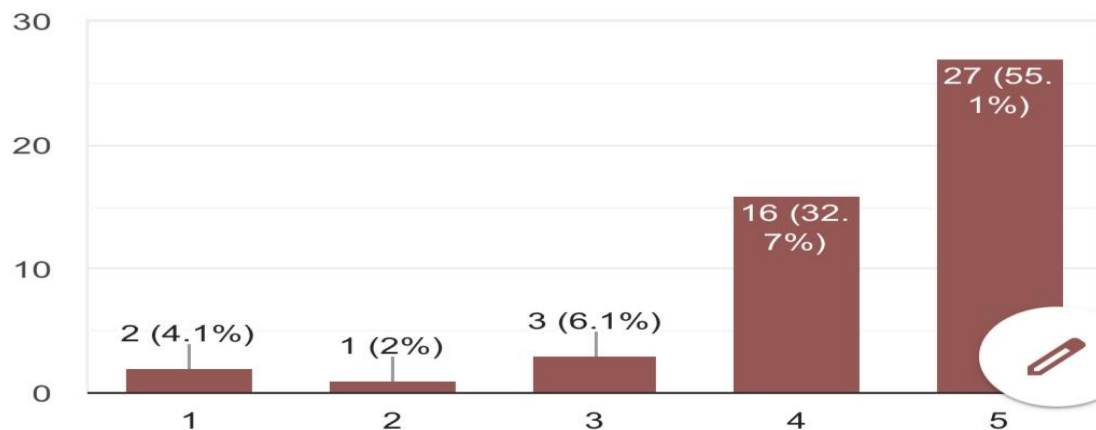
49 responses



6. How satisfied are you with your overall experience using UPI-based digital banking apps?

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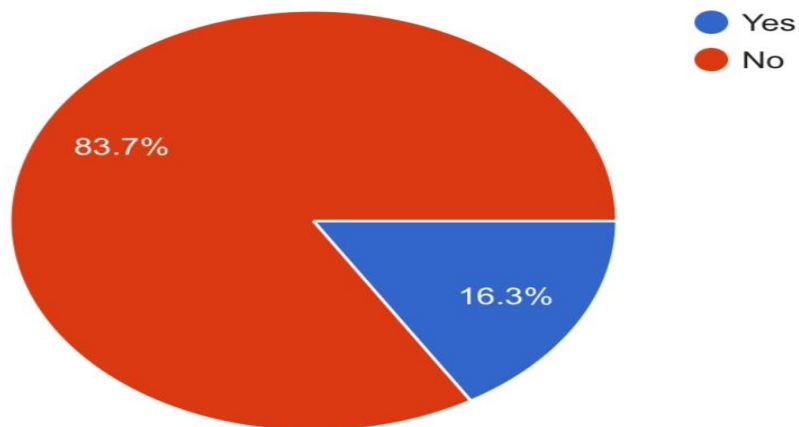
49 responses



7. Have you ever stopped using a digital banking app/service?

49 responses

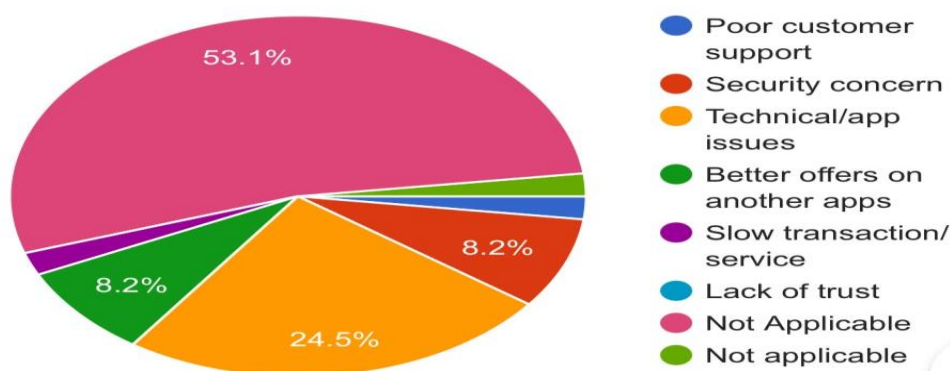
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8. What is the main reason for discontinuing the use of a UPI-based digital banking app?

49 responses

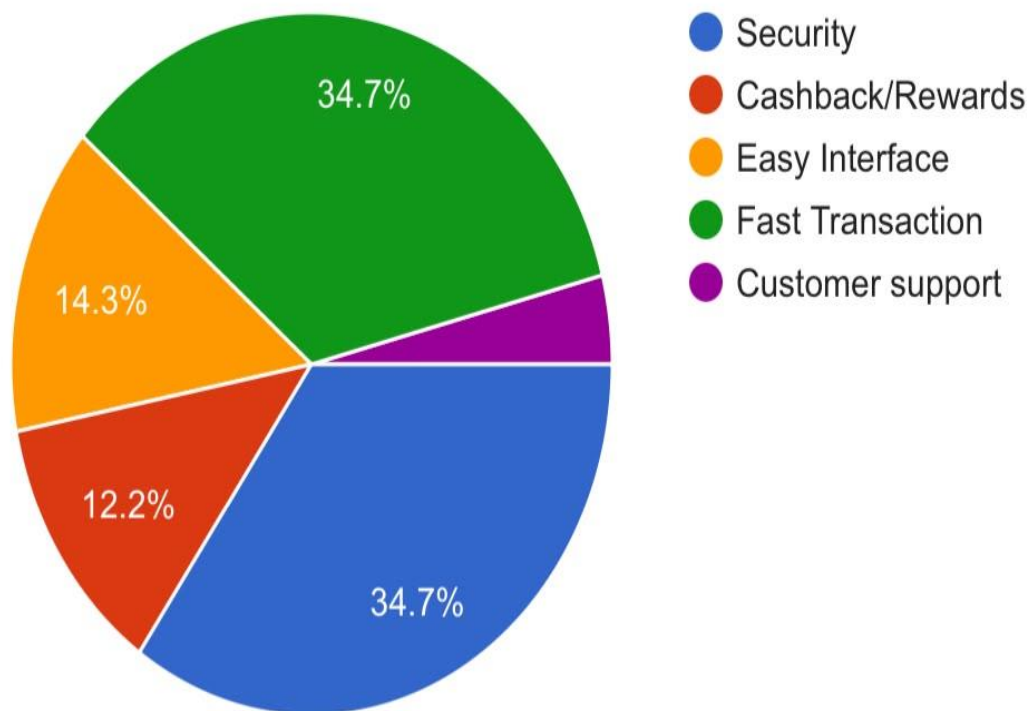
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9. What is the most important factor for you while using a digital banking platform?

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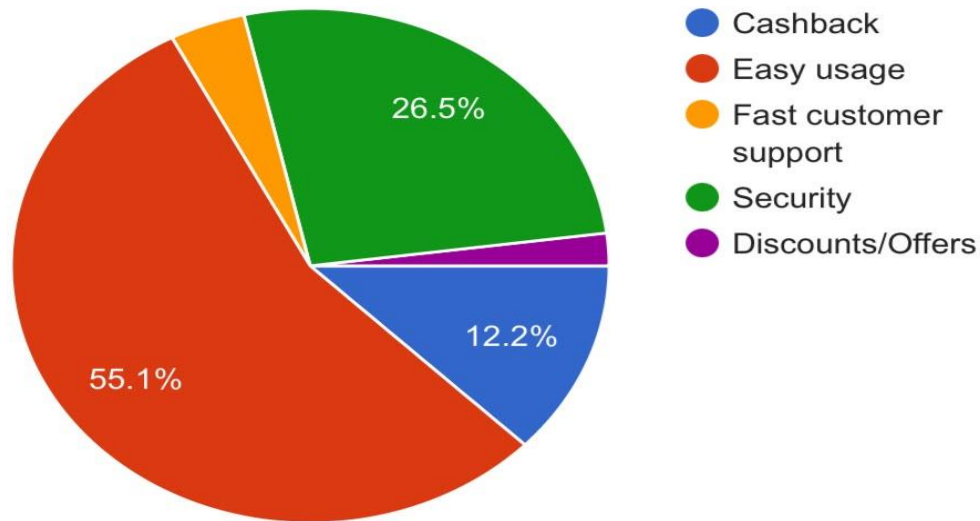
49 responses



10. Which factor makes you stay loyal to a digital banking app?

49 responses

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11. Do attractive offers Motivate you to continue using the same app?

49 responses

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